

Gasparilla Sound-Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserve

SEACAR Habitat Analyses

Last compiled on 10 June, 2026

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Funding & Acknowledgements

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Threshold Filtering

Threshold filters, following the guidance of Florida Department of Environmental Protection's (*FDEP*) Division of Environmental Assessment and Restoration (*DEAR*) are used to exclude specific results values from the SEACAR Analysis. Based on the threshold filters, Quality Assurance / Quality Control (*QAQC*) Flags are inserted into the *SEACAR_QAQCFlagCode* and *SEACAR_QAQC_Description* columns of the export data. The *Include* column indicates whether the *QAQC* Flag will also indicate that data are excluded from analysis. No data are excluded from the data export, but the analysis scripts can use the *Include* column to exclude data (1 to include, 0 to exclude).

Table 1: Continuous Water Quality threshold values

<i>Parameter Name</i>	<i>Units</i>	<i>Low Threshold</i>	<i>High Threshold</i>
Chlorophyll a, Uncorrected for Pheophytin	ug/L	-	-
Dissolved Oxygen	mg/L	-0.000001	50
Dissolved Oxygen Saturation	%	-0.000001	500
Fluorescent Dissolved Organic Matter	QSE	-	-
Salinity	ppt	-0.000001	70
Specific Conductivity	mS/cm	-0.000001	200
Turbidity	NTU	-0.000001	4000
Water Temperature	Degrees C	-5.000000	45
pH	None	2.000000	14

Table 2: Discrete Water Quality threshold values

<i>Parameter Name</i>	<i>Units</i>	<i>Low Threshold</i>	<i>High Threshold</i>
Ammonia, Un-ionized (NH3)	mg/L	-	-
Ammonium (NH4)	mg/L	-	-

<i>Parameter Name</i>	<i>Units</i>	<i>Low Threshold</i>	<i>High Threshold</i>
Chlorophyll a, Corrected for Pheophytin	ug/L	-	-
Chlorophyll a, Uncorrected for Pheophytin	ug/L	-	-
Colored Dissolved Organic Matter	PCU	-	-
Dissolved Oxygen	mg/L	-0.000001	25
Dissolved Oxygen Saturation	%	-0.000001	310
Fluorescent Dissolved Organic Matter	QSE	-	-
Light Extinction Coefficient	m ⁻¹	-	-
NO2+3, Filtered	mg/L	-	-
Nitrate (NO3)	mg/L	-	-
Nitrite (NO2)	mg/L	-	-
Nitrogen, inorganic	mg/L	-	-
Nitrogen, organic	mg/L	-	-
Phosphate, Filtered (PO4)	mg/L	-	-
Salinity	ppt	-0.000001	70
Secchi Depth	m	0.000001	50
Specific Conductivity	mS/cm	0.005000	100
Total Ammonia (N)	mg/L	-	-
Total Kjeldahl Nitrogen	mg/L	-	-
Total Nitrogen	mg/L	-	-
Total Nitrogen	mg/L	-	-
Total Phosphorus	mg/L	-	-
Total Suspended Solids	mg/L	-	-
Turbidity	NTU	-	-
Water Temperature	Degrees C	3.000000	40
pH	None	2.000000	13

Table 3: Quality Assurance Flags inserted based on threshold checks listed in Table 1 and 2

<i>SEACAR QAQC Description</i>	<i>Include</i>	<i>SEACAR QAQCFlagCode</i>
Exceeds maximum threshold	0	2Q
Below minimum threshold	0	4Q
Within threshold tolerance	1	6Q
No defined thresholds for this parameter	1	7Q

Value Qualifiers

Value qualifier codes included within the data are used to exclude certain results from the analysis. The data are retained in the data export files, but the analysis uses the *Include* column to filter the results.

STORET and WIN value qualifier codes

Value qualifier codes from *STORET* and *WIN* data are examined with the database and used to populate the *Include* column in data exports.

Table 4: Value Qualifier codes excluded from analysis

<i>Qualifier Source</i>	<i>Value Qualifier</i>	<i>Include</i>	<i>MDL</i>	<i>Description</i>
STORET-WIN	H	0	0	Value based on field kit determination; results may not be accurate
STORET-WIN	J	0	0	Estimated value
STORET-WIN	V	0	0	Analyte was detected at or above method detection limit
STORET-WIN	Y	0	0	Lab analysis from an improperly preserved sample; data may be inaccurate

Discrete Water Quality Value Qualifiers

The following value qualifiers are highlighted in the Discrete Water Quality section of this report. An exception is made for **Program 476** - *Charlotte Harbor Estuaries Volunteer Water Quality Monitoring Network* and data flagged with Value Qualifier **H** are included for this program only.

H - Value based on field kit determination; results may not be accurate. This code shall be used if a field screening test (e.g., field gas chromatograph data, immunoassay, or vendor-supplied field kit) was used to generate the value and the field kit or method has not been recognized by the Department as equivalent to laboratory methods.

I - The reported value is greater than or equal to the laboratory method detection limit but less than the laboratory practical quantitation limit.

Q - Sample held beyond the accepted holding time. This code shall be used if the value is derived from a sample that was prepared or analyzed after the approved holding time restrictions for sample preparation or analysis.

S - Secchi disk visible to bottom of waterbody. The value reported is the depth of the waterbody at the location of the Secchi disk measurement.

U - Indicates that the compound was analyzed for but not detected. This symbol shall be used to indicate that the specified component was not detected. The value associated with the qualifier shall be the laboratory method detection limit. Unless requested by the client, less than the method detection limit values shall not be reported

Systemwide Monitoring Program (SWMP) value qualifier codes

Value qualifier codes from the *SWMP* continuous program are examined with the database and used to populate the *Include* column in data exports. *SWMP* Qualifier Codes are indicated by *QualifierSource=SWMP*.

Table 5: SWMP Value Qualifier codes

<i>Qualifier Source</i>	<i>Value Qualifier</i>	<i>Include</i>	<i>Description</i>
SWMP	-1	1	Optional parameter not collected
SWMP	-2	0	Missing data
SWMP	-3	0	Data rejected due to QA/QC
SWMP	-4	0	Outside low sensor range
SWMP	-5	0	Outside high sensor range
SWMP	0	1	Passed initial QA/QC checks
SWMP	1	0	Suspect data
SWMP	2	1	Reserved for future use
SWMP	3	1	Calculated data: non-vented depth/level sensor correction for changes in barometric pressure
SWMP	4	1	Historical: Pre-auto QA/QC
SWMP	5	1	Corrected data

Water Column

The water column habitat extends from the water's surface to the bottom sediments, and it's where fish, dolphins, crabs and people swim! So much life makes its home in the water column that the health of marine and coastal ecosystems, as well as human economies, depend on the condition of this vulnerable habitat. Local patterns of rainfall, temperature, winds and currents can rapidly change the condition of the water column, while global influences such as [El Niño/La Niña](#), large-scale fluctuation in sea temperatures and climate change can have long-term effects. Inputs from the prosperity of our day-to-day lives including farming, mining and forestry, and emissions from power generation, automobiles and water treatment can also alter the health of the water column. Acting alone or together, each input can have complex and lasting effects on habitats and ecosystems.

SEACAR evaluates water column health with several essential parameters. These include nutrient surveys of nitrogen and phosphorus, and water quality assessments of salinity, dissolved oxygen, pH, and water temperature. Water clarity is evaluated with Secchi depth, turbidity, levels of chlorophyll a, total suspended solids, and colored dissolved organic matter. Additionally, the richness of nekton is indicated by the abundance of free-swimming fishes and macroinvertebrates like crabs and shrimps.

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Analysis

Indicators must have a minimum of five to ten years, depending on the habitat, of data within the geographic range of the analysis to be included in the analysis. Ten years of data are required for discrete parameters, and five years of data are required for continuous parameters. If there are insufficient years of data, the number of years of data available will be noted and labeled as "insufficient data to conduct analysis". Further, for the preferred Seasonal Kendall-Tau test, there must be data from at least two months in common across at least two consecutive years within the RCP managed area being analyzed. Values that pass both of these tests will be included in the analysis and be labeled as *Use_In_Analysis* = **TRUE**. Any that fail either test will be excluded from the analyses and labeled as *Use_In_Analysis* = **FALSE**. The points for all Water Column plots displayed in this section are monthly averages. Trend significance will be denoted as "Significant Trend" (when $p < 0.05$), or "Non-significant Trend" (when $p \geq 0.05$). Any parameters with insufficient data to perform Seasonal Kendall-Tau test will have their monthly averages plotted without a corresponding trend line.

Water Quality - Discrete

The following files were used in the discrete analysis:

- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Chlorophyll_a_corrected_for_pheophytin-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Chlorophyll_a_uncorrected_for_pheophytin-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Colored_dissolved_organic_matter_CDOM-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Dissolved_Oxygen-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Dissolved_Oxygen_Saturation-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_pH-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Salinity-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Secchi_Depth-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Total_Nitrogen-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Total_Phosphorus-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Total_Suspended_Solids_TSS-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Turbidity-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Water_Temperature-2026-May-18.txt*

Chlorophyll a, Corrected for Pheophytin - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

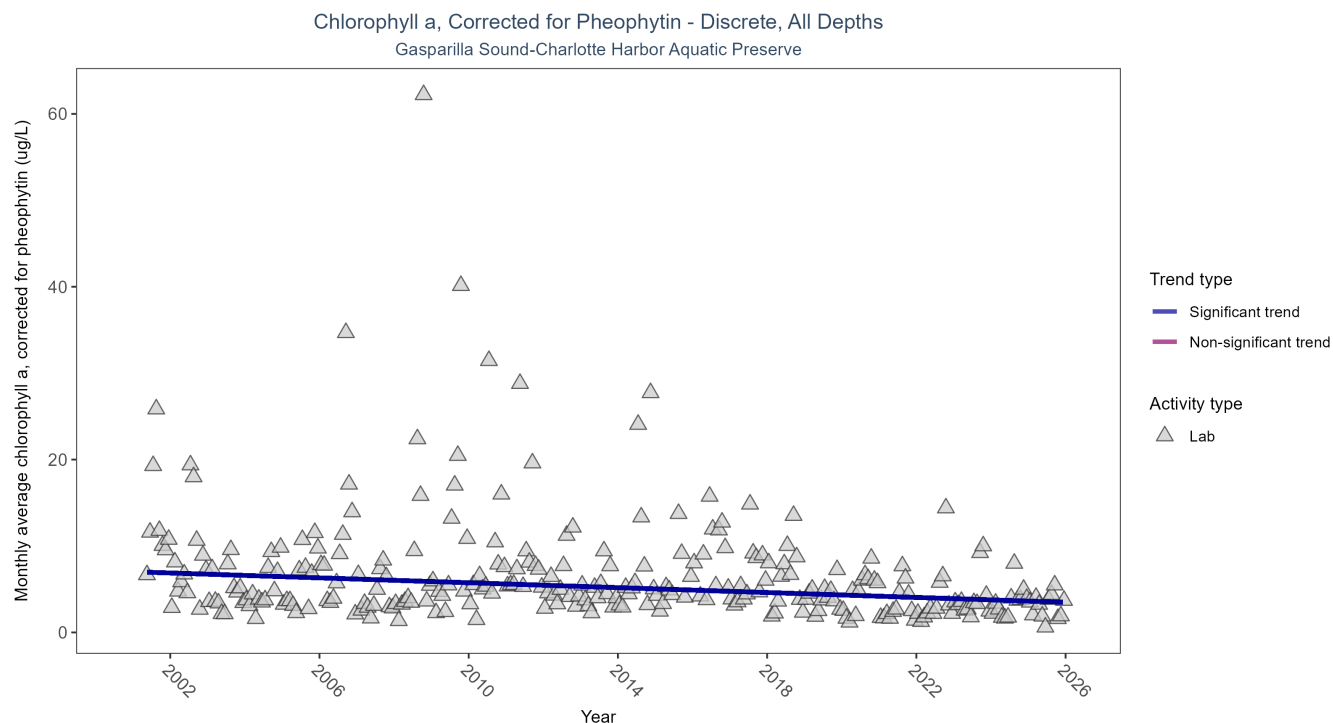


Figure 1: Scatter plot of monthly average levels of chlorophyll a, corrected for pheophytin, over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only laboratory-analyzed chlorophyll a (triangles) is included in the plot.

Table 6: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Chlorophyll a, Corrected for Pheophytin

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Lab	Decreasing trend	5012	25	2001 - 2025	3.6	-0.2713	7.0214	-0.1415	0

Monthly average chlorophyll a, corrected for pheophytin, decreased by 0.14 $\mu\text{g/L}$ per year, indicating an increase in water clarity.

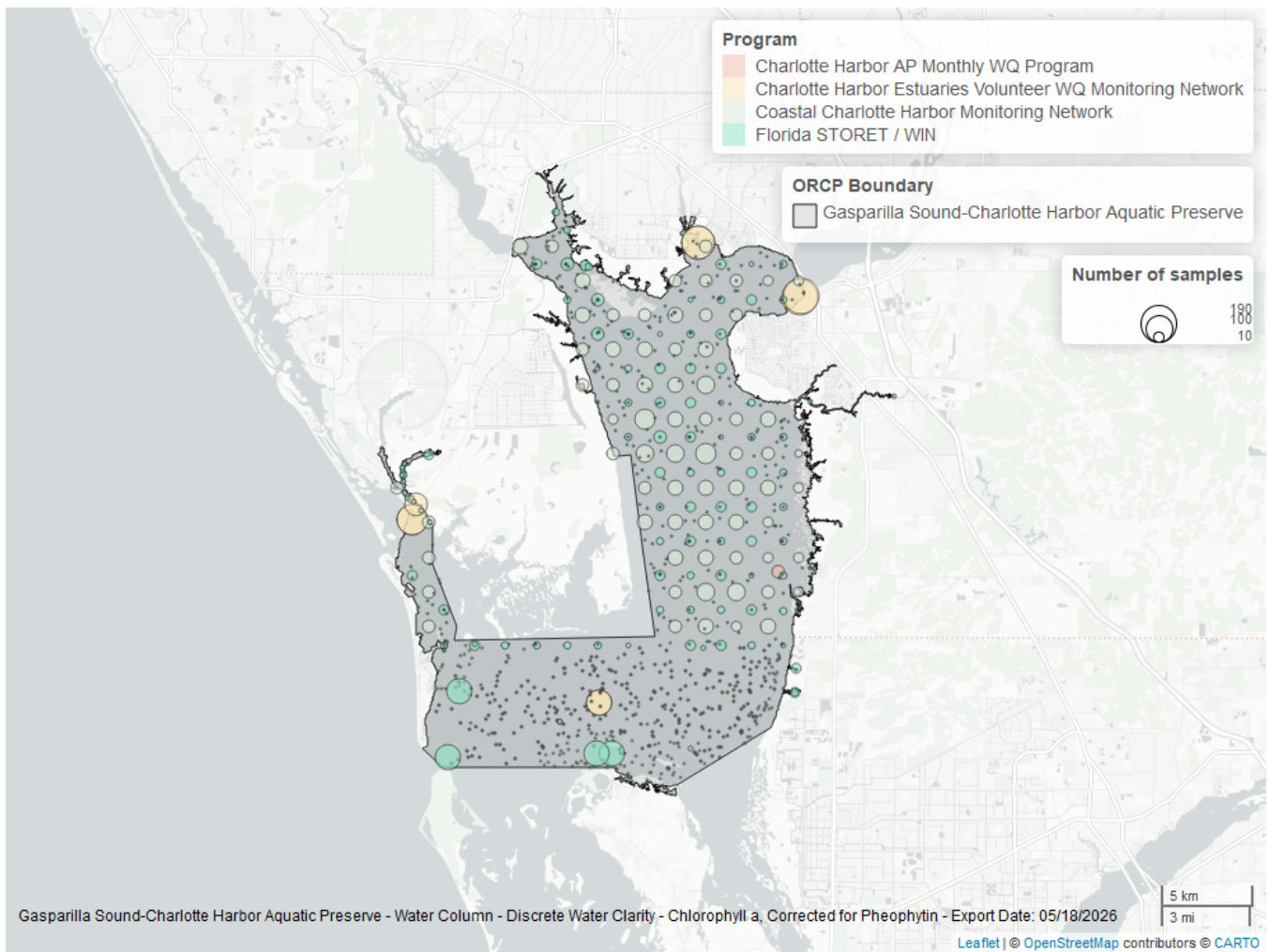


Figure 2: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Gasparilla Sound-Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 7: Programs contributing data for Chlorophyll a, Corrected for Pheophytin

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
513	2714	2001	2025
5002	1655	2001	2025
476	674	2008	2025
5028	22	2024	2025

Program names:

513 - Coastal Charlotte Harbor Monitoring Network¹

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN²

476 - Charlotte Harbor Estuaries Volunteer Water Quality Monitoring Network³

5028 - Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves Monthly Water Quality Program⁴

Chlorophyll a, Uncorrected for Pheophytin - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

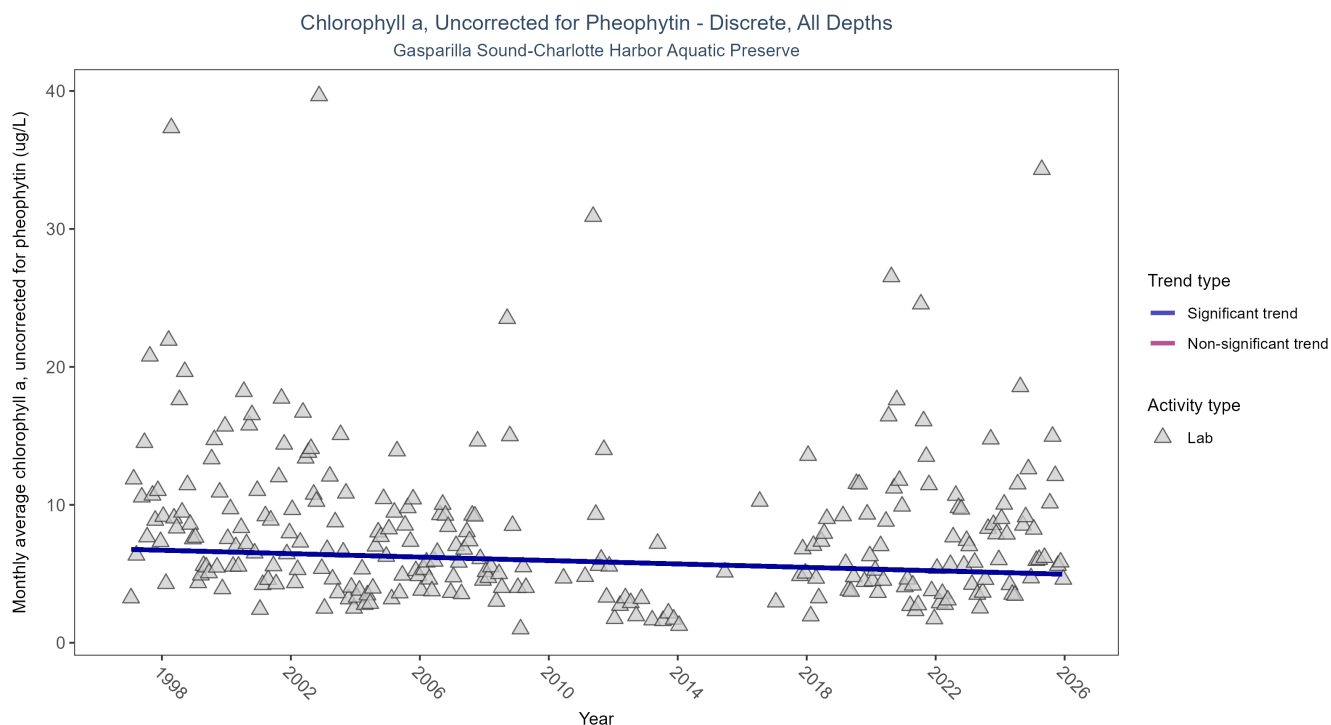


Figure 3: Scatter plot of monthly average levels of chlorophyll a, uncorrected for pheophytin, over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only laboratory-analyzed chlorophyll a (triangles) is included in the plot.

Table 8: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Chlorophyll a, Uncorrected for Pheophytin

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Lab	Decreasing trend	2484	29	1997 - 2025	4.855	-0.1317	6.7702	-0.0621	0.0038

Monthly average chlorophyll a, uncorrected for pheophytin, decreased by 0.06 $\mu\text{g/L}$ per year, indicating an increase in water clarity.

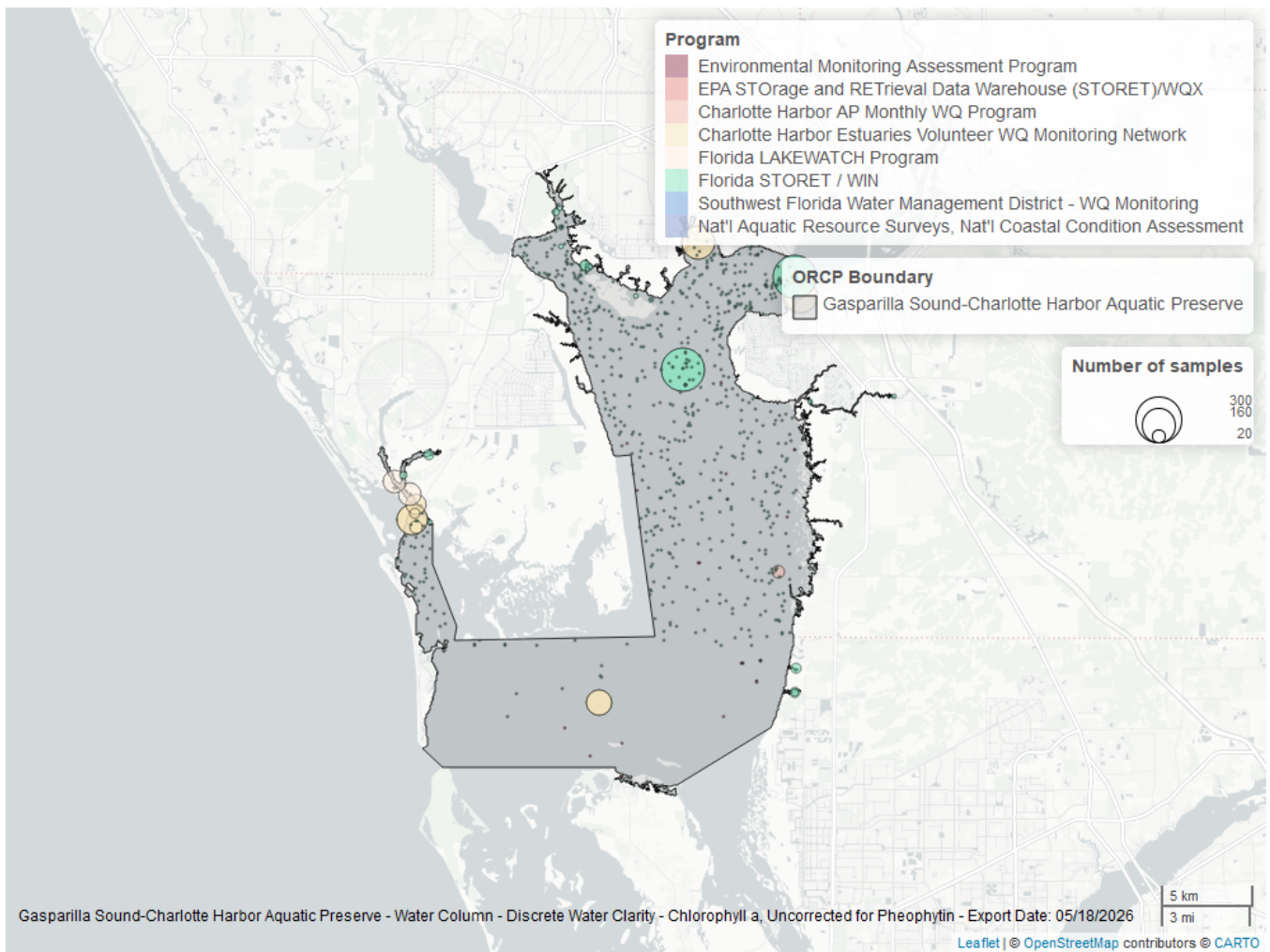


Figure 4: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Gasparilla Sound-Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 9: Programs contributing data for Chlorophyll a, Uncorrected for Pheophytin

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
5002	1583	1997	2025
476	707	1998	2025
514	165	2000	2009
5028	22	2024	2025
103	20	2000	2015
115	6	2000	2004
118	5	2000	2010
479	2	2002	2002

Program names:

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN²

[476](#) - Charlotte Harbor Estuaries Volunteer Water Quality Monitoring Network³

514 - Florida LAKEWATCH Program⁵

[5028](#) - Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves Monthly Water Quality Program⁴

103 - EPA STORage and RETrieval Data Warehouse (STORET)/WQX⁶
 115 - Environmental Monitoring Assessment Program⁷
 118 - National Aquatic Resource Surveys, National Coastal Condition Assessment⁸
 479 - Southwest Florida Water Management District - Water Quality Monitoring⁹

Colored Dissolved Organic Matter - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

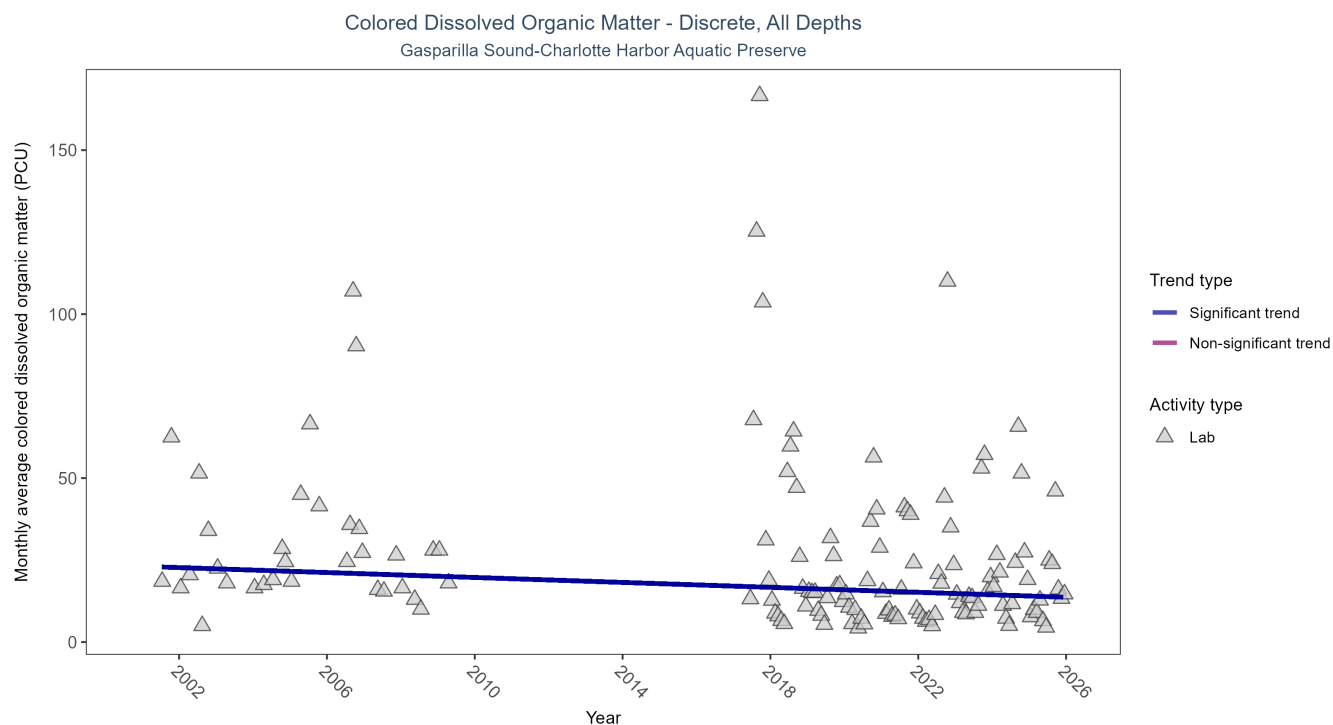


Figure 5: Scatter plot of monthly average colored dissolved organic matter (CDOM) over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only laboratory-analyzed CDOM (triangles) is included in the plot.

Table 10: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Colored Dissolved Organic Matter

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Lab	Decreasing trend	1369	18	2001 - 2025	12.9	-0.1914	23.091	-0.3765	0.002

Monthly average colored dissolved organic matter decreased by 0.38 PCU per year, indicating an increase in water clarity.

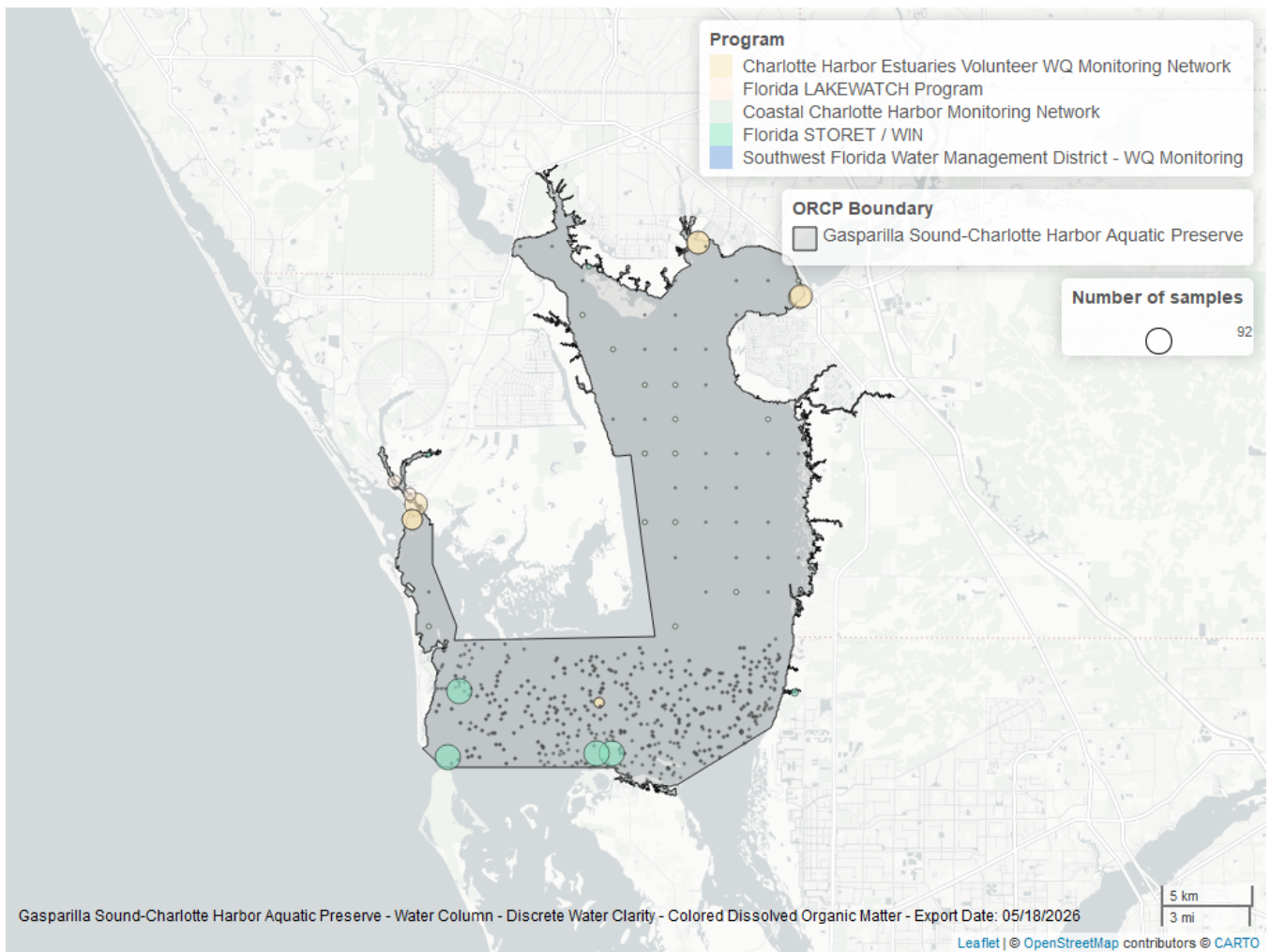


Figure 6: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Gasparilla Sound-Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 11: Programs contributing data for Colored Dissolved Organic Matter

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
513	807	2006	2025
476	310	2017	2025
5002	205	2018	2025
514	49	2001	2009
479	2	2002	2002

Program names:

513 - Coastal Charlotte Harbor Monitoring Network¹

476 - Charlotte Harbor Estuaries Volunteer Water Quality Monitoring Network³

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN²

514 - Florida LAKEWATCH Program⁵

479 - Southwest Florida Water Management District - Water Quality Monitoring⁹

Dissolved Oxygen - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

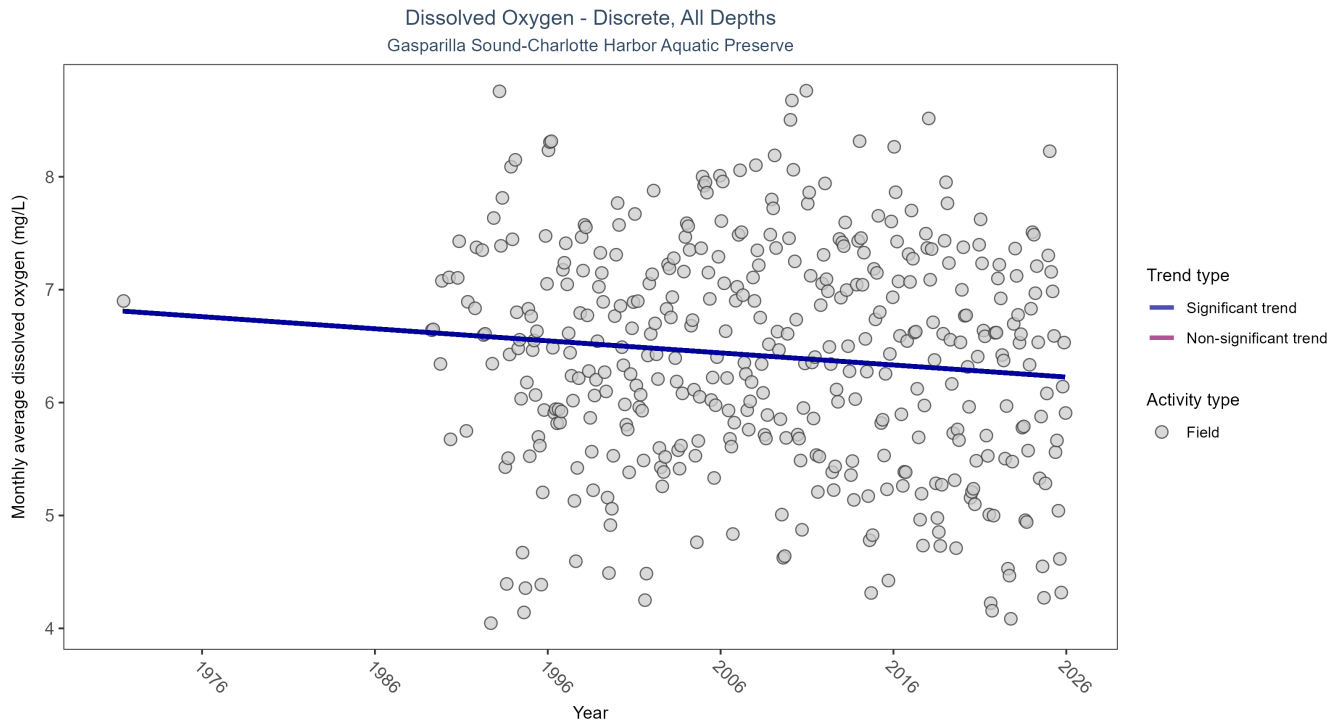


Figure 7: Scatter plot of monthly average dissolved oxygen over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only dissolved oxygen values measured in the field (circles) are included in the plot.

Table 12: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Dissolved Oxygen

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Field	Decreasing trend	77941	38	1971 - 2025	6.55	-0.1411	6.8145	-0.0107	0

Monthly average dissolved oxygen decreased by 0.01 mg/L per year.

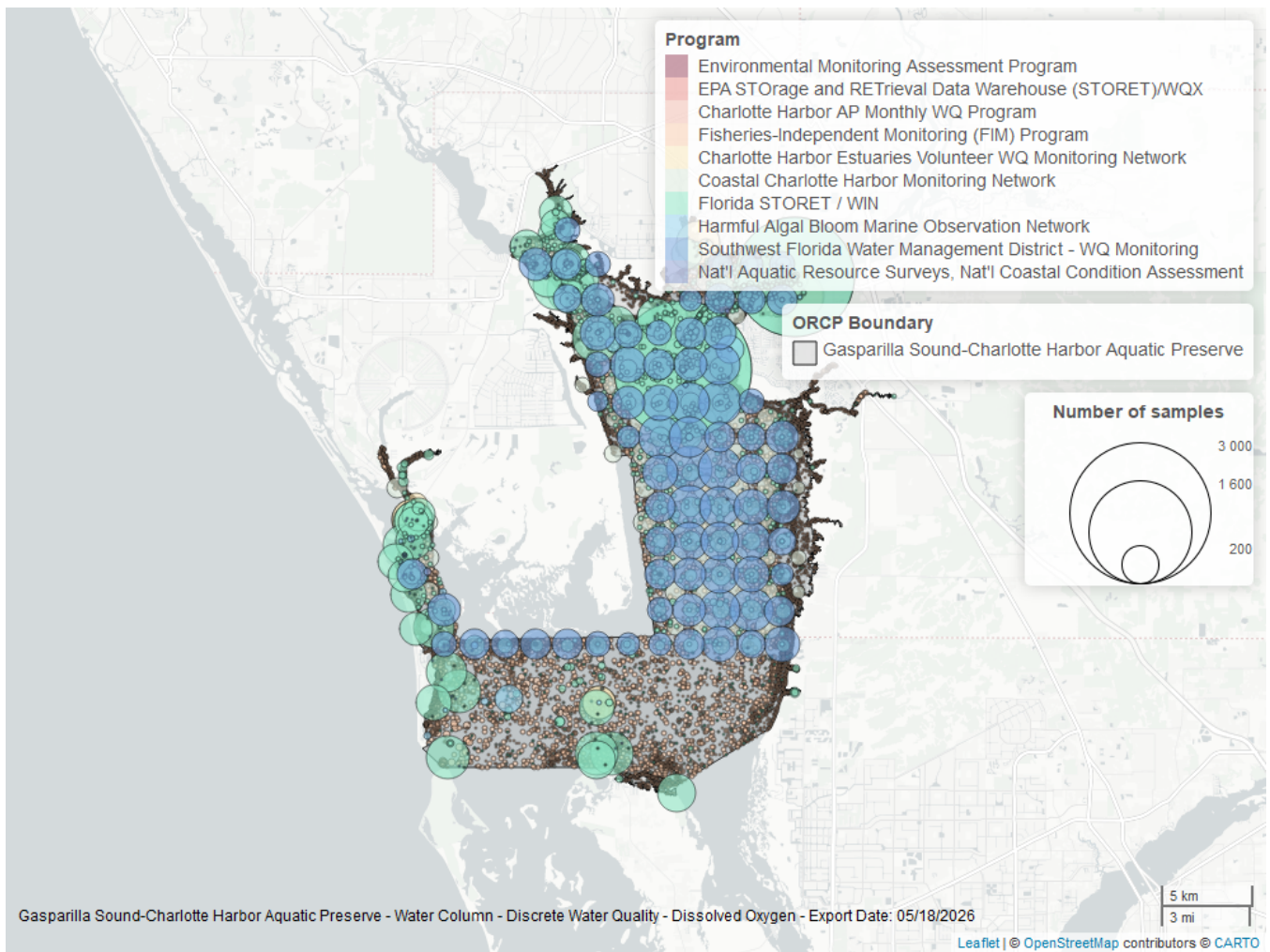


Figure 8: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Gasparilla Sound-Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 13: Programs contributing data for Dissolved Oxygen

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
69	38206	1989	2024
5002	20875	1993	2025
479	11958	2001	2016
513	5411	2001	2025
476	1140	1996	2025
95	395	1971	2018
118	32	2000	2020
115	24	2000	2004
5028	24	2024	2025
103	14	2015	2015

Program names:

69 - Fisheries-Independent Monitoring (FIM) Program¹⁰

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN²

479 - Southwest Florida Water Management District - Water Quality Monitoring⁹
 513 - Coastal Charlotte Harbor Monitoring Network¹
 476 - Charlotte Harbor Estuaries Volunteer Water Quality Monitoring Network³
 95 - Harmful Algal Bloom Marine Observation Network¹¹
 118 - National Aquatic Resource Surveys, National Coastal Condition Assessment⁸
 115 - Environmental Monitoring Assessment Program⁷
 5028 - Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves Monthly Water Quality Program⁴
 103 - EPA STORage and RETrieval Data Warehouse (STORET)/WQX⁶

Dissolved Oxygen Saturation - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

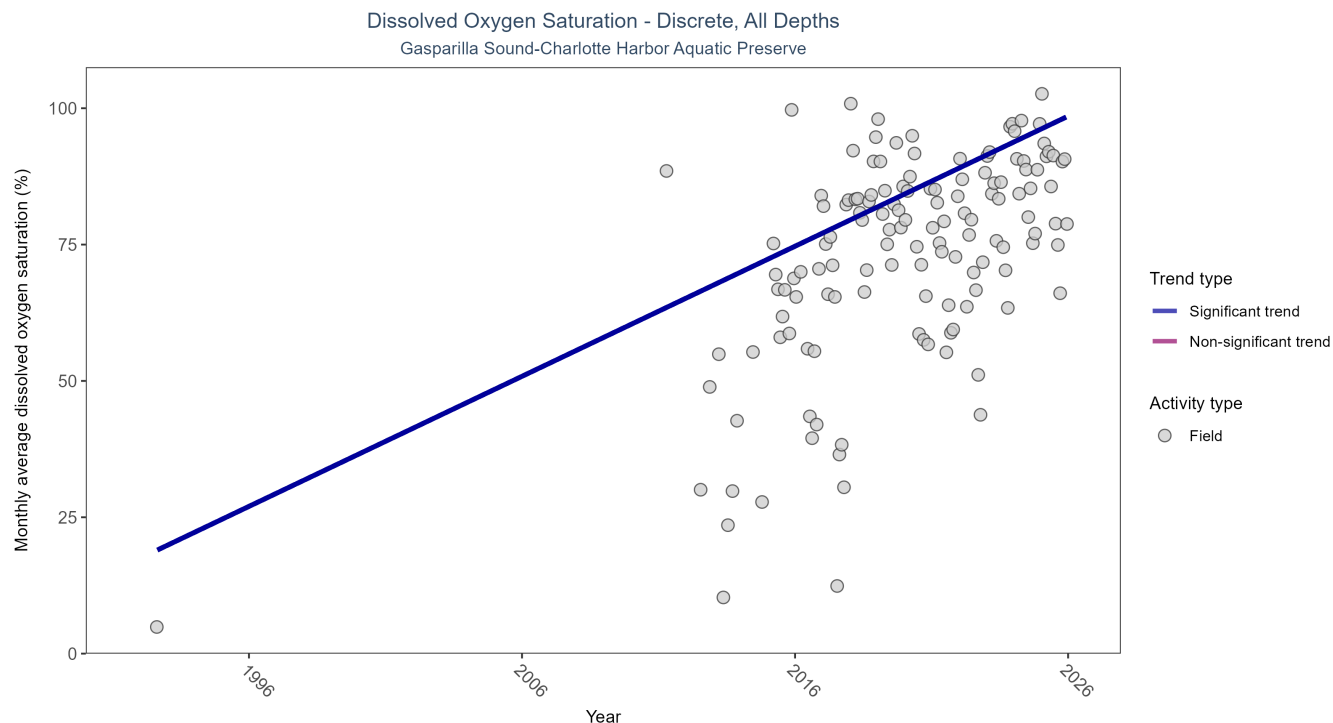


Figure 9: Scatter plot of monthly average dissolved oxygen saturation over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only dissolved oxygen saturation values measured in the field (circles) are included in the plot.

Table 14: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Dissolved Oxygen Saturation

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Field	Increasing trend	957	16	1992 - 2025	87.7	0.4769	17.4531	2.3852	0

Monthly average dissolved oxygen saturation increased by 2.39% per year.

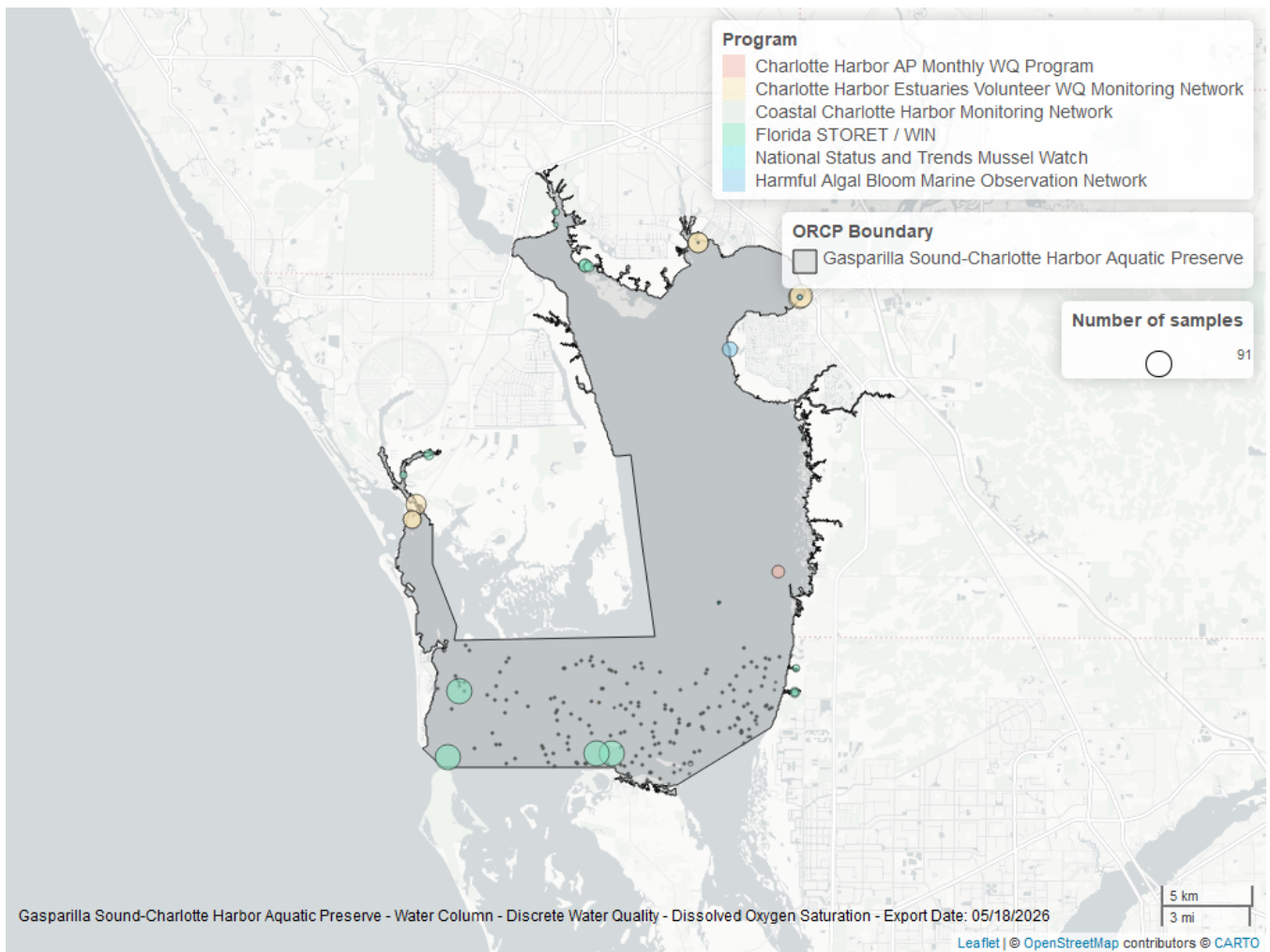


Figure 10: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Gasparilla Sound-Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 15: Programs contributing data for Dissolved Oxygen Saturation

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
513	350	2020	2025
5002	307	2012	2025
476	269	2016	2025
95	43	2011	2018
5028	26	2024	2025
102	6	1992	1992

Program names:

513 - Coastal Charlotte Harbor Monitoring Network¹

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN²

476 - Charlotte Harbor Estuaries Volunteer Water Quality Monitoring Network³

95 - Harmful Algal Bloom Marine Observation Network¹¹

5028 - Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves Monthly Water Quality Program⁴

102 - National Status and Trends Mussel Watch¹²

pH - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

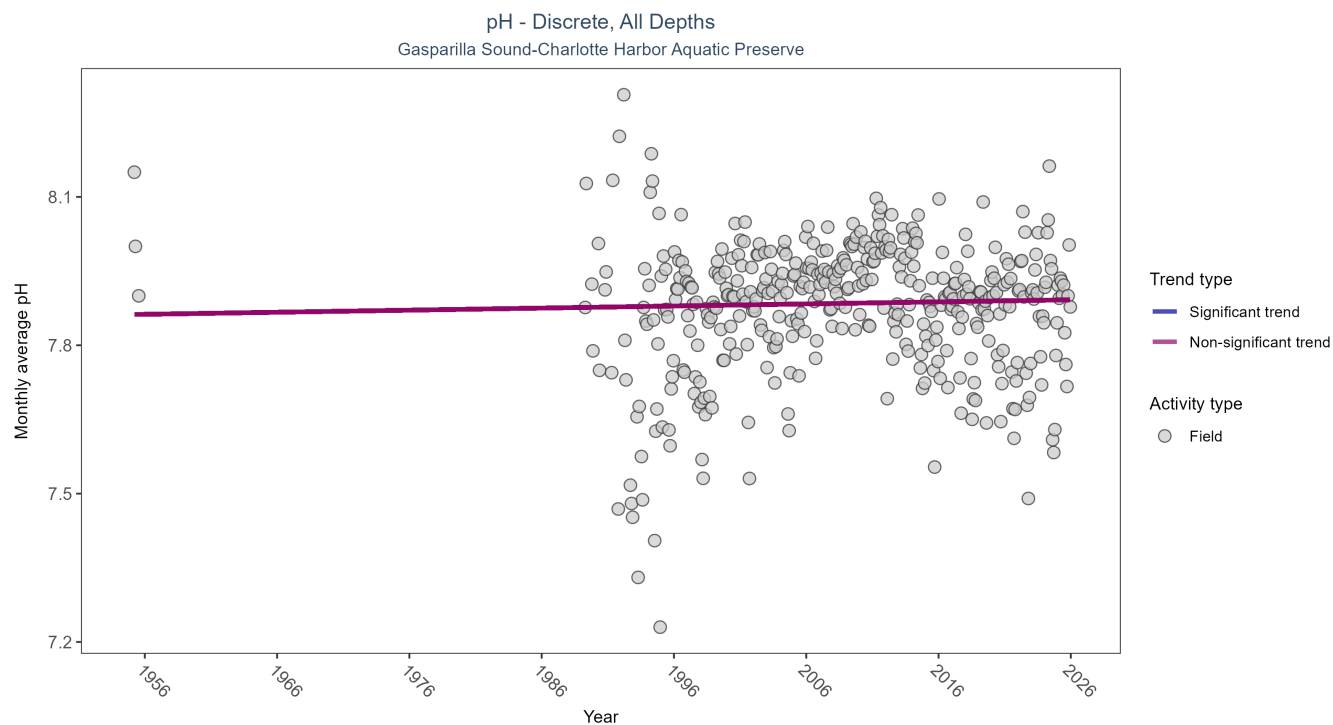


Figure 11: Scatter plot of monthly average pH over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only pH values measured in the field (circles) are included in the plot.

Table 16: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for pH

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Field	No detectable trend	74598	38	1955 - 2025	7.91	0.032	7.8622	0.0004	0.3759

pH showed no detectable trend between 1955 and 2025.

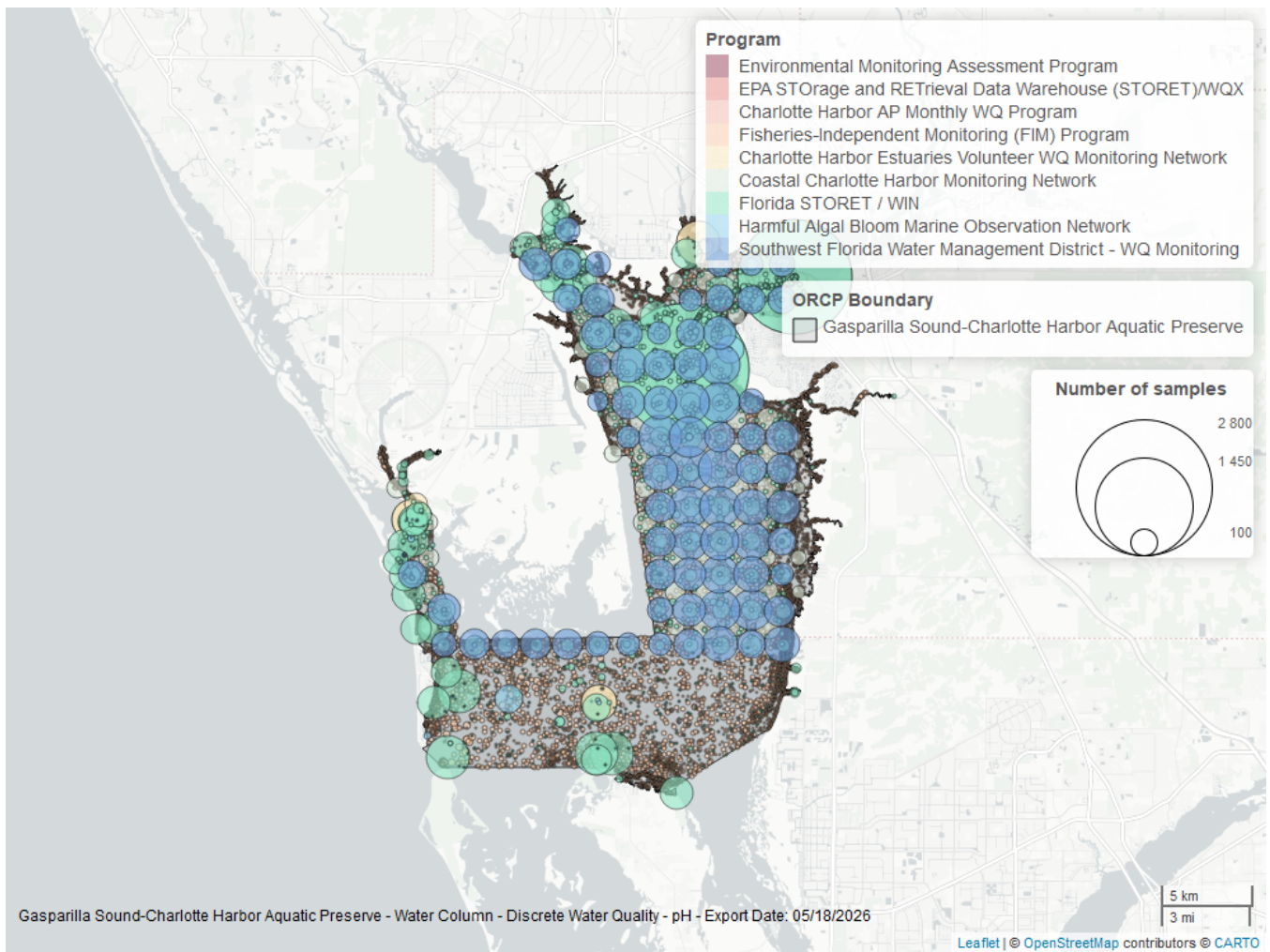


Figure 12: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Gasparilla Sound-Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 17: Programs contributing data for pH

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
69	37757	1989	2024
5002	18170	1993	2025
479	11746	2001	2016
513	5361	2001	2025
476	1175	1996	2025
95	365	1955	2018
5028	27	2024	2025
115	24	2000	2004
103	17	2015	2015

Program names:

69 - Fisheries-Independent Monitoring (FIM) Program¹⁰

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN²

479 - Southwest Florida Water Management District - Water Quality Monitoring⁹

513 - Coastal Charlotte Harbor Monitoring Network¹
476 - Charlotte Harbor Estuaries Volunteer Water Quality Monitoring Network³
95 - Harmful Algal Bloom Marine Observation Network¹¹
5028 - Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves Monthly Water Quality Program⁴
115 - Environmental Monitoring Assessment Program⁷
103 - EPA STORage and RETrieval Data Warehouse (STORET)/WQX⁶

Salinity - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

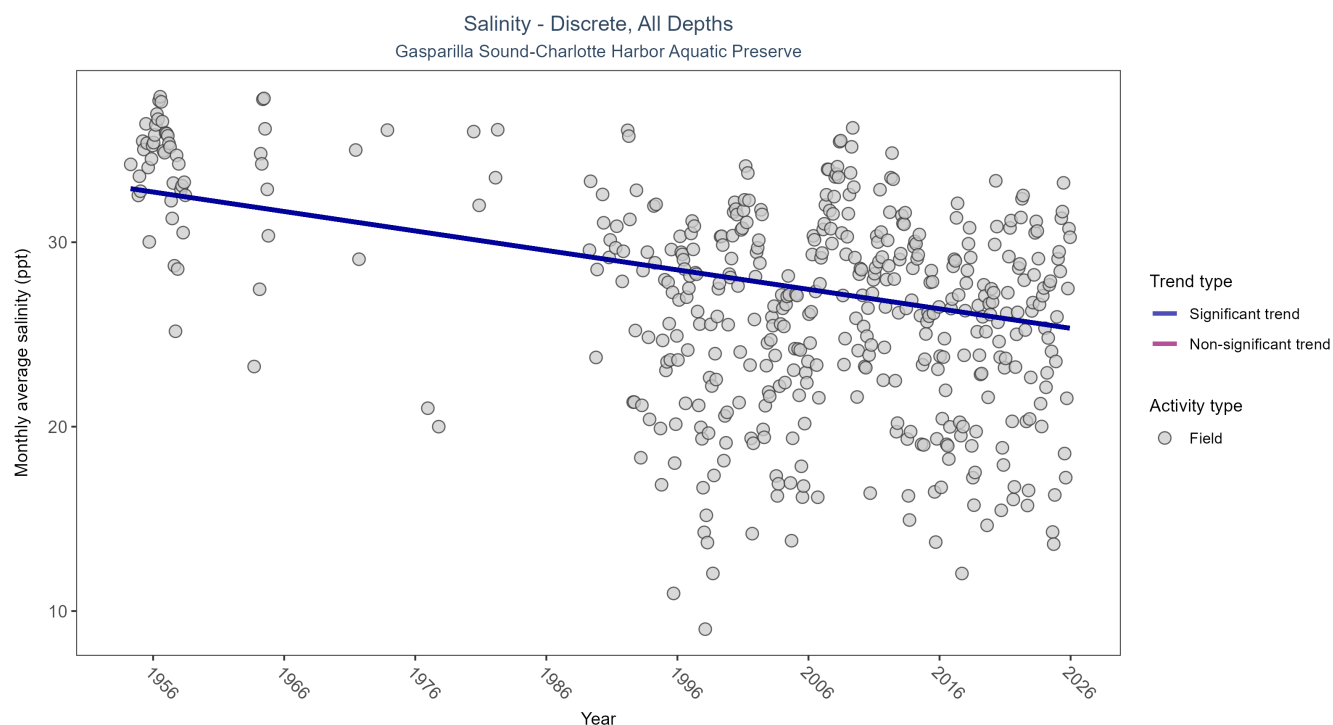


Figure 13: Scatter plot of monthly average salinity over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines are also shown. Discrete salinity values derived from grab samples analyzed in the field (circles) or the laboratory (triangles) are both included in the plot.

Table 18: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Salinity

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
All	Decreasing trend	76143	50	1954 - 2025	26.69	-0.2622	32.9348	-0.1056	0

Monthly average salinity decreased by 0.11 ppt per year.

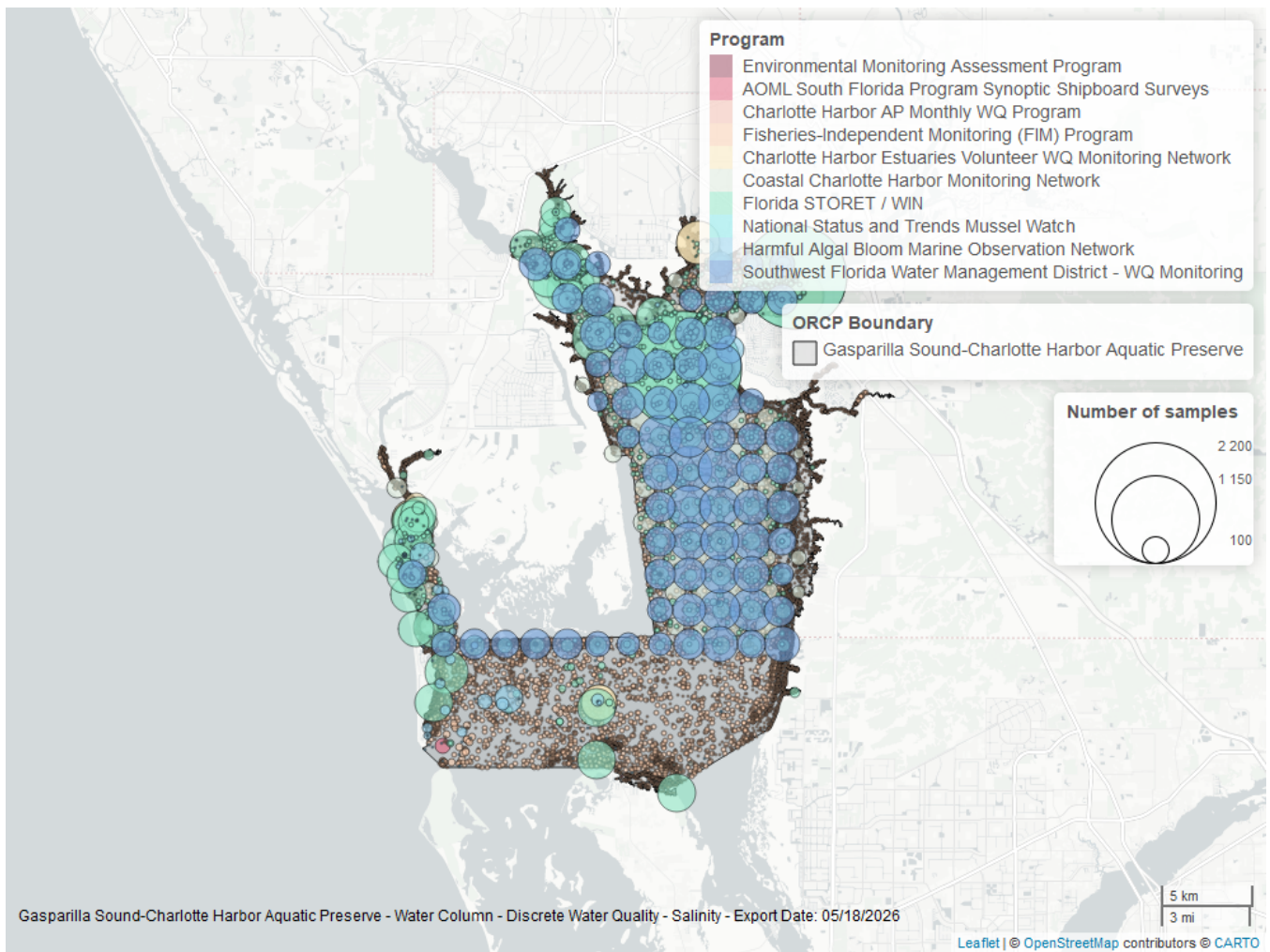


Figure 14: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Gasparilla Sound-Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 19: Programs contributing data for Salinity

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
69	38552	1989	2024
5002	18569	1995	2025
479	11924	2001	2016
513	5075	2001	2025
476	1169	1996	2025
95	778	1954	2018
3	42	2001	2010
5028	26	2024	2025
115	24	2000	2004
102	6	1992	1992

Program names:

69 - Fisheries-Independent Monitoring (FIM) Program¹⁰

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN²

479 - Southwest Florida Water Management District - Water Quality Monitoring⁹
 513 - Coastal Charlotte Harbor Monitoring Network¹
 476 - Charlotte Harbor Estuaries Volunteer Water Quality Monitoring Network³
 95 - Harmful Algal Bloom Marine Observation Network¹¹
 3 - Atlantic Oceanographic and Meteorological Laboratory (AOML) South Florida Program Synoptic Shipboard Surveys¹³
 5028 - Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves Monthly Water Quality Program⁴
 115 - Environmental Monitoring Assessment Program⁷
 102 - National Status and Trends Mussel Watch¹²

Total Nitrogen - Discrete

Total Nitrogen Calculation:

The logic for calculated Total Nitrogen was provided by Kevin O'Donnell and colleagues at FDEP (with the help of Jay Silvanima, Watershed Monitoring Section). The following logic is used, in this order, based on the availability of specific nitrogen components.

- 1) $TN = TKN + NO3O2$;
- 2) $TN = TKN + NO3 + NO2$;
- 3) $TN = ORGN + NH4 + NO3O2$;
- 4) $TN = ORGN + NH4 + NO2 + NO3$;
- 5) $TN = TKN + NO3$;
- 6) $TN = ORGN + NH4 + NO3$;

Additional Information:

- Rules for use of sample fraction:
 - Florida Department of Environmental Protection (FDEP) report that if both “Total” and “Dissolved” components are reported, only “Total” is used. If the total is not reported, then the dissolved components are used as a best available replacement.
 - Total nitrogen calculations are done using nitrogen components with the same sample fraction, nitrogen components with mixed total/dissolved sample fractions are not used. In other words, total nitrogen can be calculated when TKN and NO3O2 are both total sample fractions, or when both are dissolved sample fractions. *Future calculations of total nitrogen values may be based on components with mixed sample fractions.*
- Values inserted into data:
 - ParameterName = “Total Nitrogen”
 - SEACAR_QAQCFlagCode = “1Q”
 - SEACAR_QAQC_Description = “SEACAR Calculated”

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

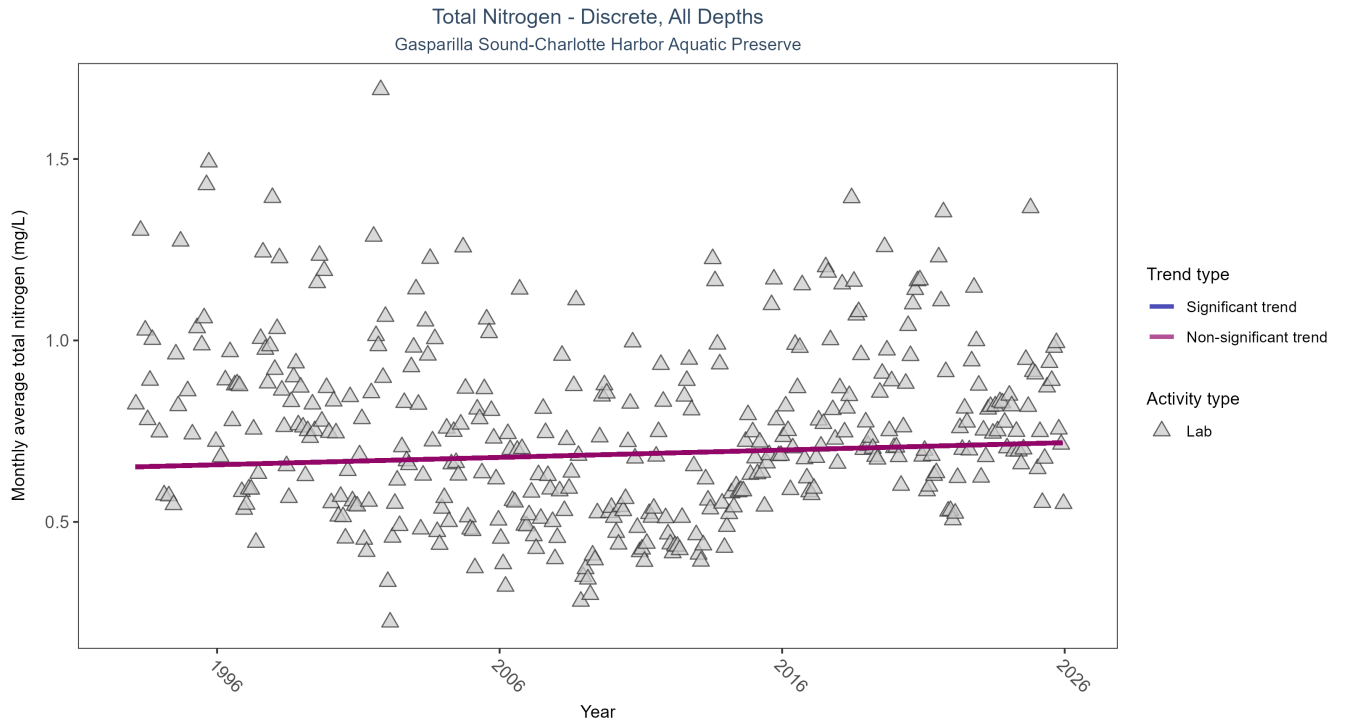


Figure 15: Scatter plot of monthly average total nitrogen over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only nitrogen values obtained from laboratory analyses (triangles) are included in the plot.

Table 20: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Total Nitrogen

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Lab	No detectable trend	11249	33	1993 - 2025	0.667	0.062	0.6514	0.002	0.1019

Total nitrogen showed no detectable trend between 1993 and 2025.

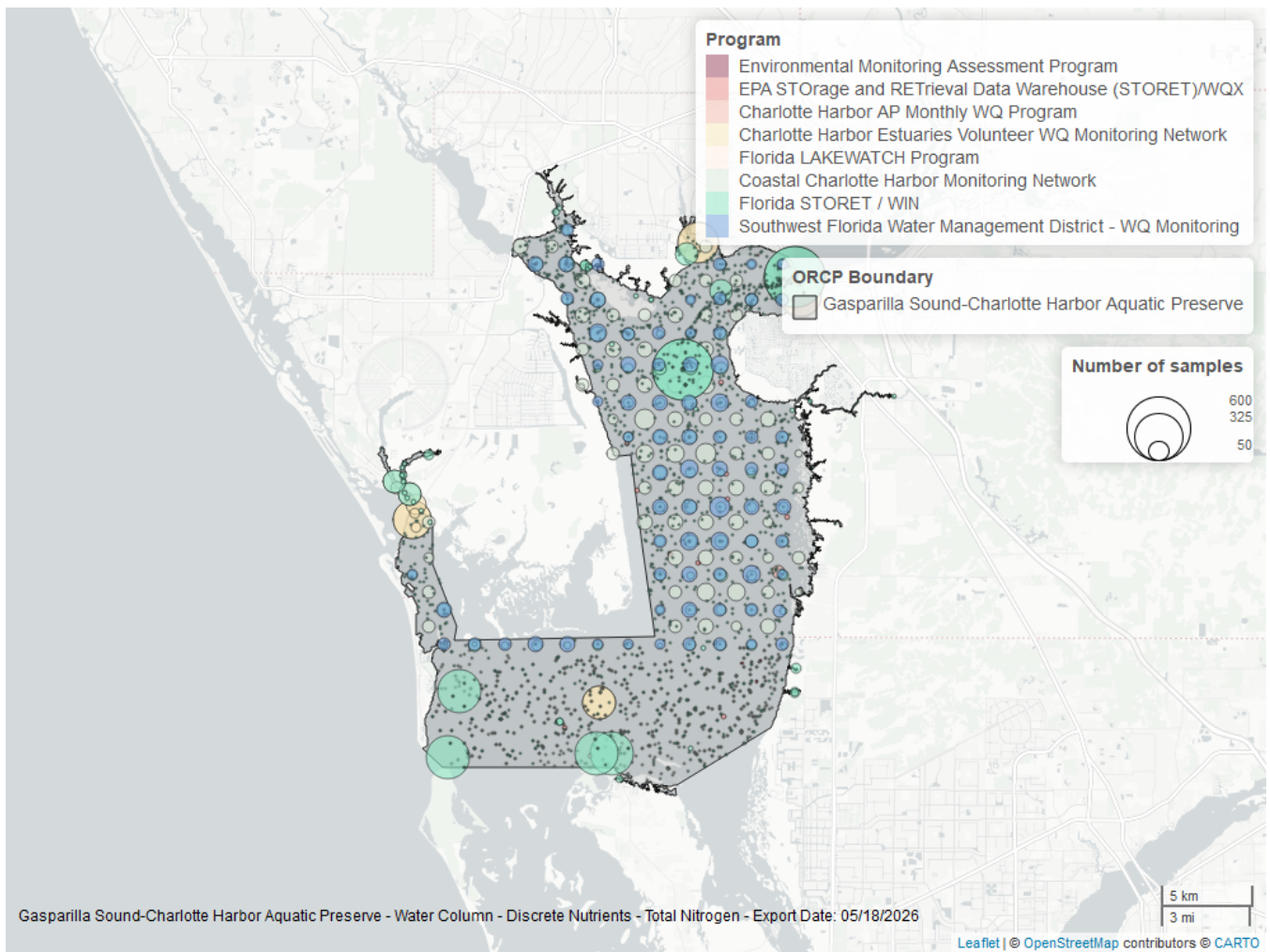


Figure 16: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Gasparilla Sound-Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 21: Programs contributing data for Total Nitrogen

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
5002	5222	1993	2025
513	2700	2001	2025
479	2134	2002	2016
476	1003	1998	2025
514	169	2000	2009
103	40	2000	2015
5028	21	2024	2025
115	4	2000	2003

Program names:

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN²

513 - Coastal Charlotte Harbor Monitoring Network¹

479 - Southwest Florida Water Management District - Water Quality Monitoring⁹

476 - Charlotte Harbor Estuaries Volunteer Water Quality Monitoring Network³

514 - Florida LAKEWATCH Program⁵
 103 - EPA STORage and RETrieval Data Warehouse (STORET)/WQX⁶
 5028 - Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves Monthly Water Quality Program⁴
 115 - Environmental Monitoring Assessment Program⁷

Total Phosphorus - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

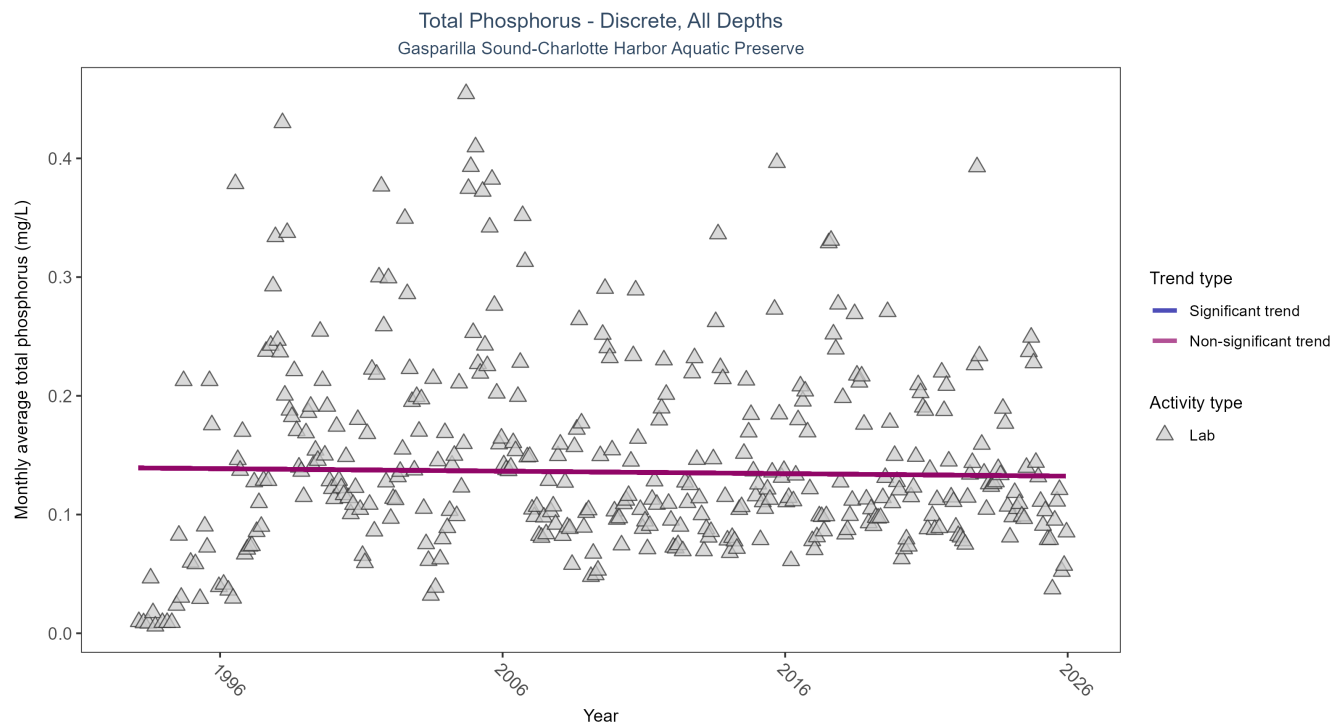


Figure 17: Scatter plot of monthly average total phosphorus over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only phosphorus values obtained from laboratory analyses (triangles) are included in the plot.

Table 22: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Total Phosphorus

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Lab	No detectable trend	10291	33	1993 - 2025	0.114	-0.0287	0.1393	-0.0002	0.5447

Total phosphorus showed no detectable trend between 1993 and 2025.

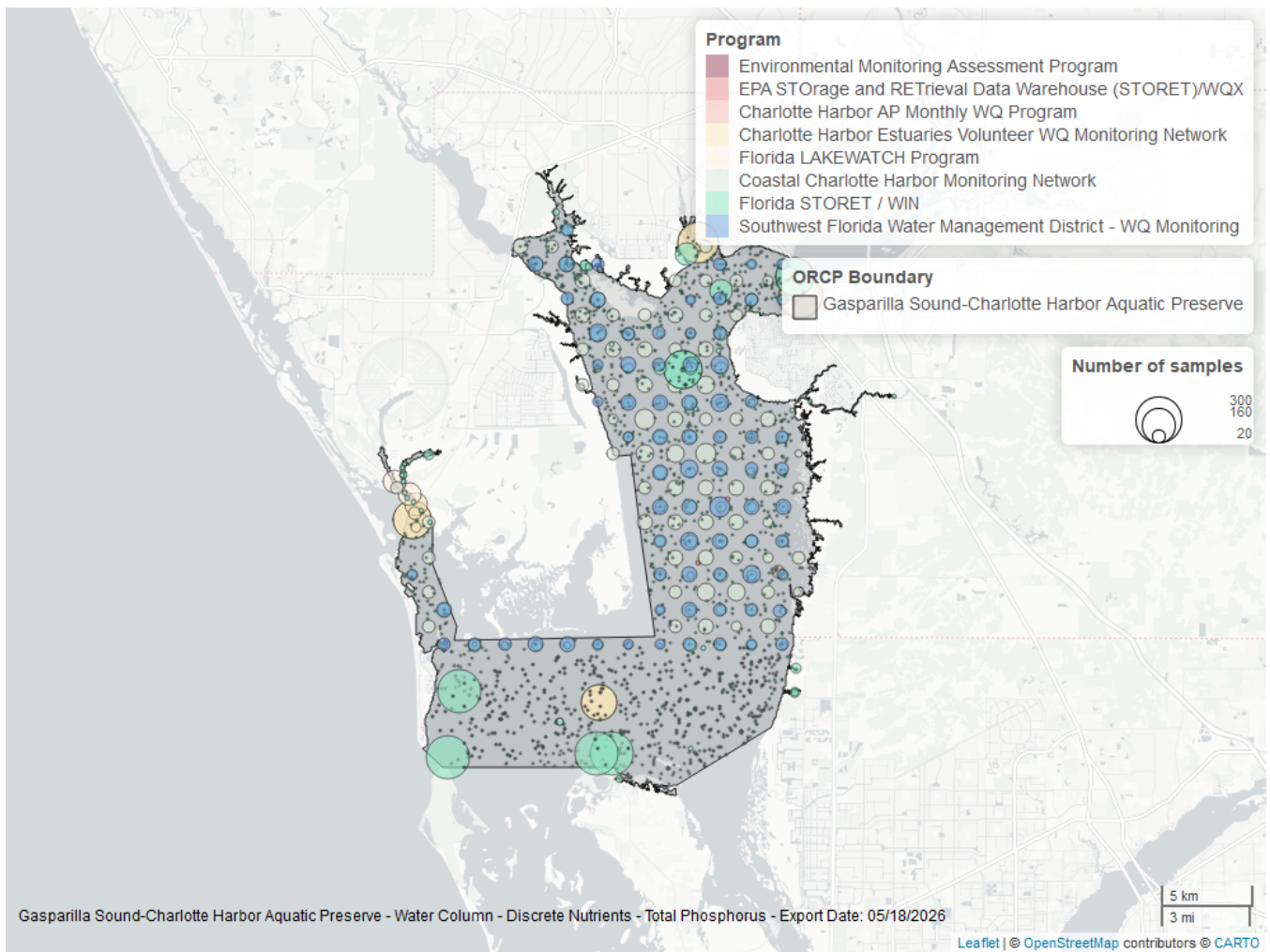


Figure 18: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Gasparilla Sound-Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 23: Programs contributing data for Total Phosphorus

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
5002	4199	1993	2025
513	2726	2001	2025
479	2118	2002	2016
476	1095	1998	2025
514	169	2000	2009
103	30	2000	2015
5028	24	2024	2025
115	4	2000	2003

Program names:

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN²

513 - Coastal Charlotte Harbor Monitoring Network¹

479 - Southwest Florida Water Management District - Water Quality Monitoring⁹

476 - Charlotte Harbor Estuaries Volunteer Water Quality Monitoring Network³

514 - Florida LAKEWATCH Program⁵
 103 - EPA STORage and RETrieval Data Warehouse (STORET)/WQX⁶
 5028 - Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves Monthly Water Quality Program⁴
 115 - Environmental Monitoring Assessment Program⁷

Turbidity - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

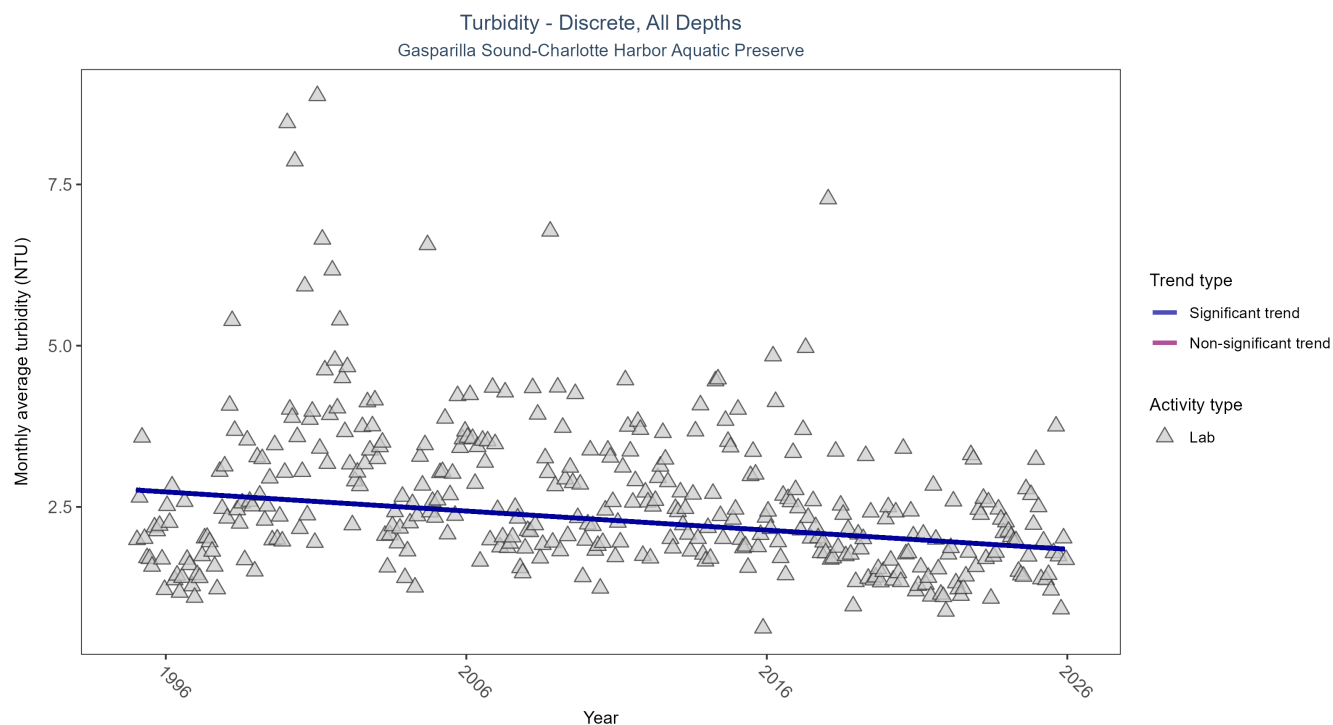


Figure 19: Scatter plot of monthly average turbidity over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only turbidity values measured in the laboratory (triangles) are included in the plot.

Table 24: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Turbidity

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Lab	Decreasing trend	15112	31	1995 - 2025	1.9	-0.2057	2.762	-0.0296	0

Monthly average turbidity decreased by 0.03 NTU per year, indicating an increase in water clarity.

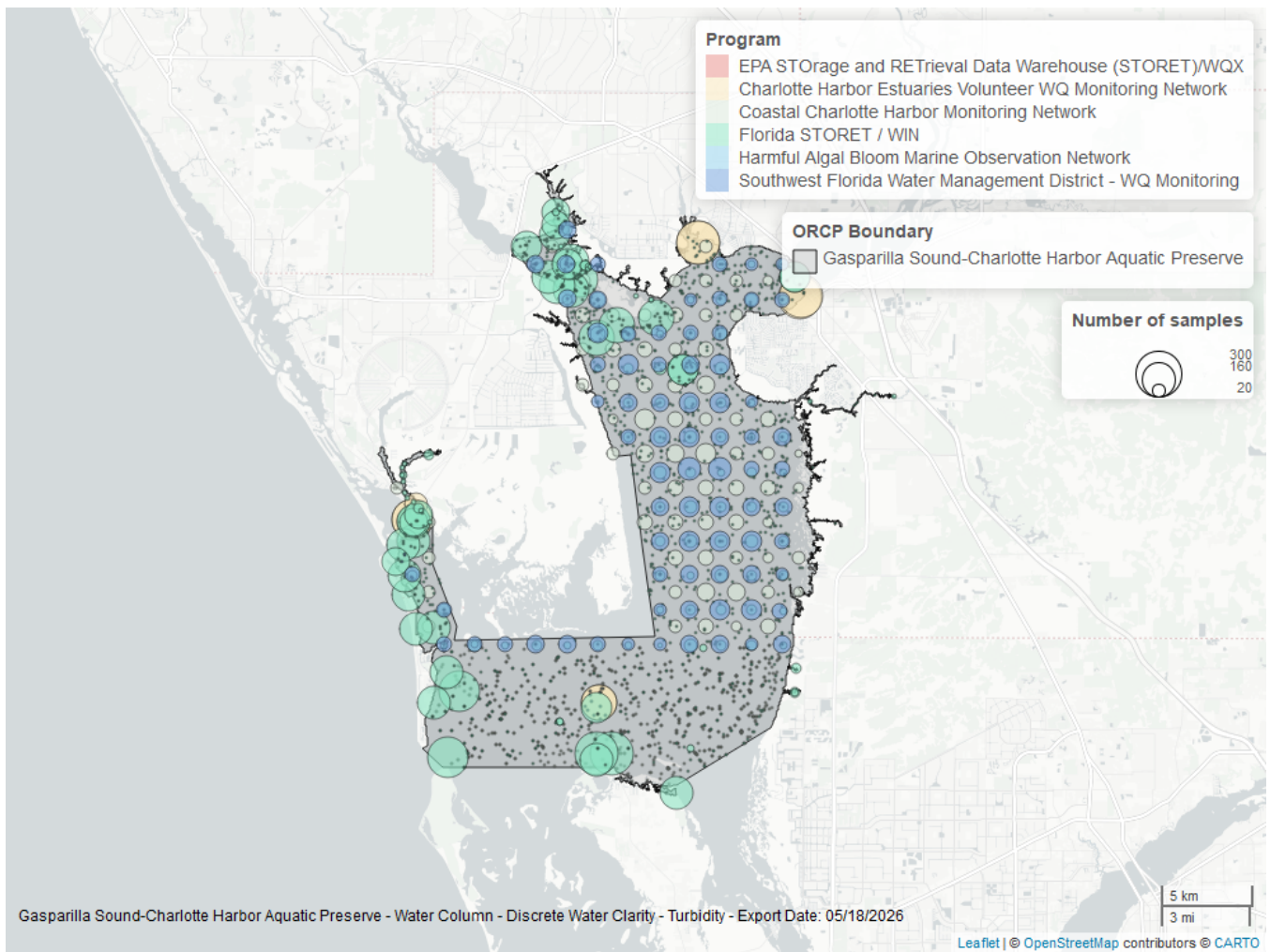


Figure 20: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Gasparilla Sound-Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 25: Programs contributing data for Turbidity

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
5002	8569	1995	2025
479	3386	2001	2016
513	2713	2001	2025
476	1140	1998	2025
95	6	2003	2003
103	2	2006	2006

Program names:

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN²

479 - Southwest Florida Water Management District - Water Quality Monitoring⁹

513 - Coastal Charlotte Harbor Monitoring Network¹

476 - Charlotte Harbor Estuaries Volunteer Water Quality Monitoring Network³

95 - Harmful Algal Bloom Marine Observation Network¹¹

103 - EPA STORage and RETrieval Data Warehouse (STORET)/WQX⁶

Water Temperature - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

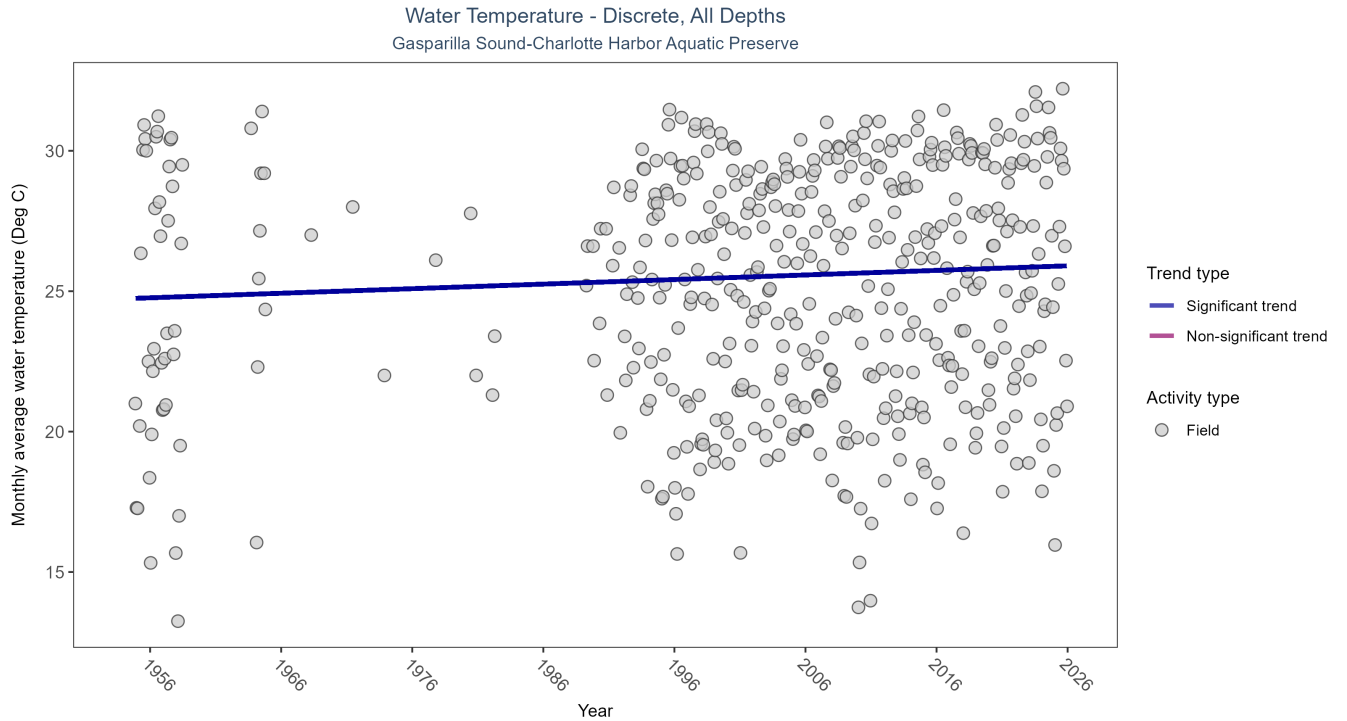


Figure 21: Scatter plot of monthly average water temperature over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only water temperature measurements taken in the field (circles) are included in the plot.

Table 26: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Water Temperature

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Field	Increasing trend	78978	50	1954 - 2025	26.095	0.1464	24.7321	0.0163	0

Monthly average water temperature increased by 0.02°C per year.

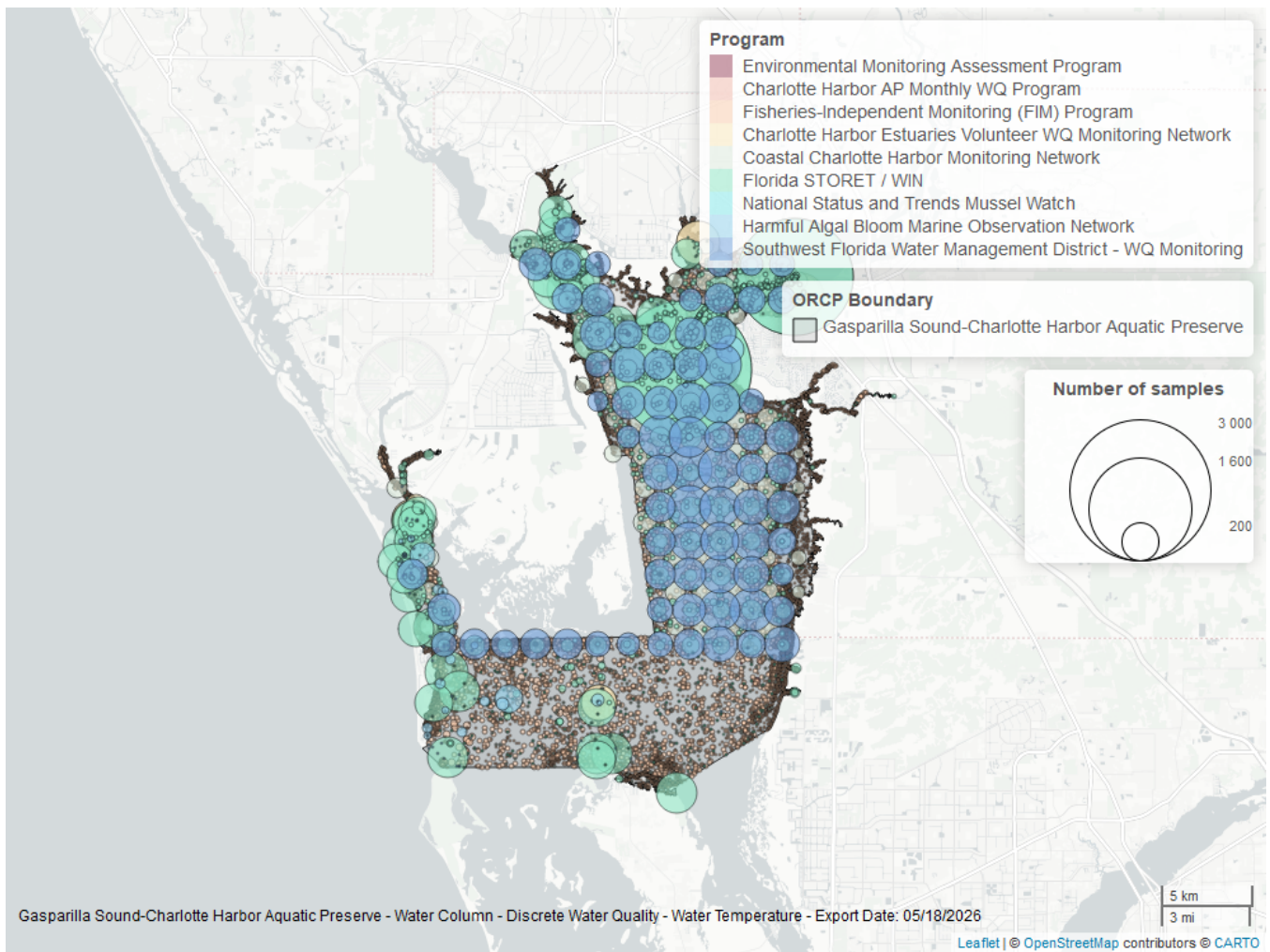


Figure 22: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Gasparilla Sound-Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 27: Programs contributing data for Water Temperature

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
69	38557	1989	2024
5002	21154	1993	2025
479	11918	2001	2016
513	5410	2001	2025
476	1173	1996	2025
95	719	1954	2018
5028	26	2024	2025
115	24	2000	2004
102	6	1992	1992

Program names:

69 - Fisheries-Independent Monitoring (FIM) Program¹⁰

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN²

479 - Southwest Florida Water Management District - Water Quality Monitoring⁹

513 - Coastal Charlotte Harbor Monitoring Network¹
476 - Charlotte Harbor Estuaries Volunteer Water Quality Monitoring Network³
95 - Harmful Algal Bloom Marine Observation Network¹¹
5028 - Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves Monthly Water Quality Program⁴
115 - Environmental Monitoring Assessment Program⁷
102 - National Status and Trends Mussel Watch¹²

Water Quality - Continuous

The following files were used in the continuous analysis:

- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_cont_Chlorophyll_a_Uncorrected_for_Pheophytin-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_cont_Dissolved_Oxygen-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_cont_Dissolved_Oxygen_Saturation-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_cont_Fluorescent_Dissolved_Organic_Matter-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_cont_pH-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_cont_Salinity-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_cont_Specific_Conductivity-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_cont_Turbidity-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_cont_Water_Temperature-2026-Mar-06.txt*

Continuous monitoring locations in Gasparilla Sound-Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserve

Table 28: Station overview for Continuous parameters by Program

<i>ProgramID</i>	<i>ProgramLocationID</i>	<i>Years of Data</i>	<i>Use in Analysis</i>	<i>Parameters</i>
7	02293252	4	FALSE	Water Temperature, Salinity
512	CHEW1	2	FALSE	pH , Dissolved Oxygen Saturation, Dissolved Oxygen , Turbidity , Water Temperature , Salinity , Specific Conductivity

Program names:

7 - National Water Information System¹⁴

512 - Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves Continuous Water Quality Monitoring¹⁵

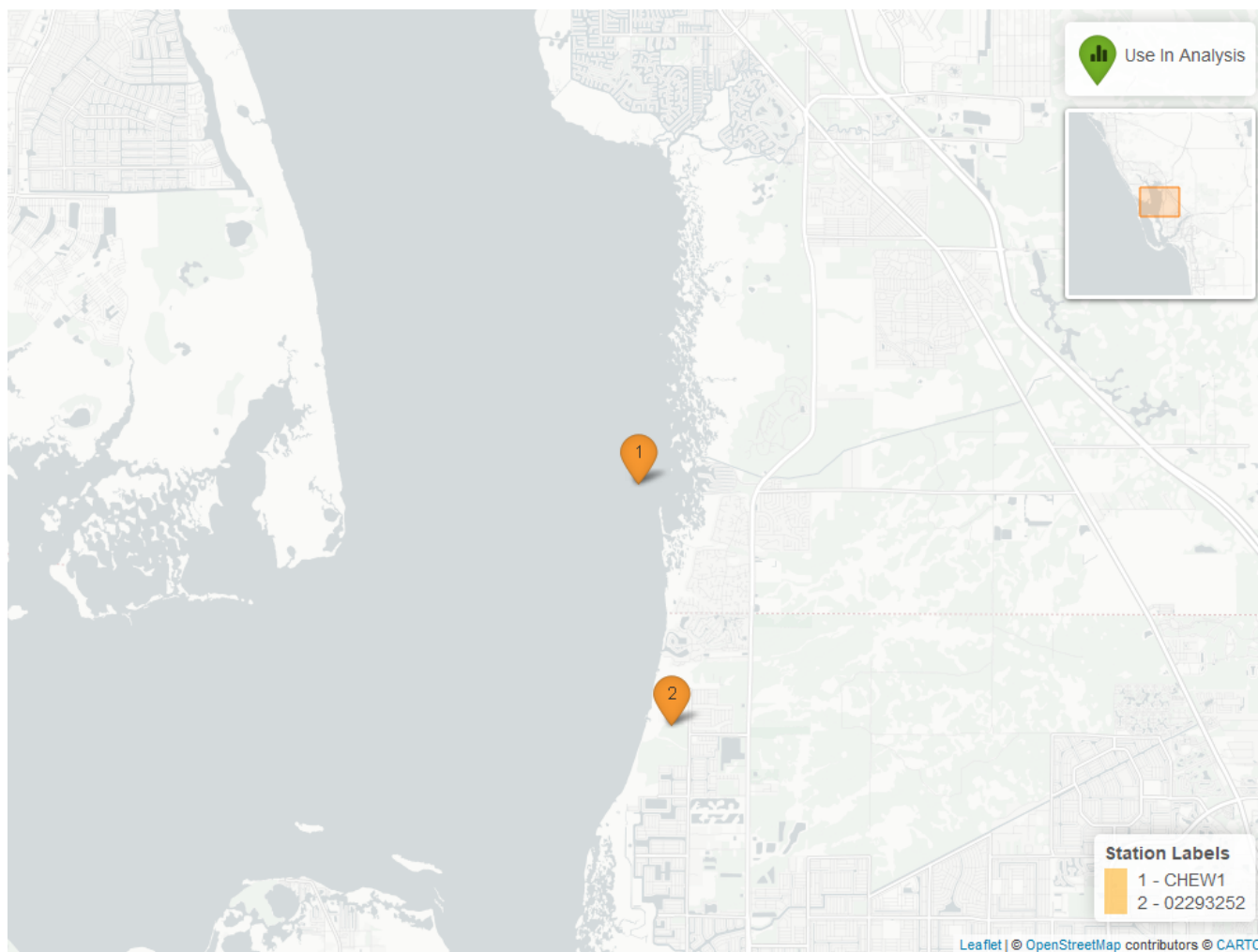


Figure 23: Map showing continuous water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Gasparilla Sound-Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserve*. Sites marked as *Use In Analysis* (green) are featured in this report.

pH - Continuous

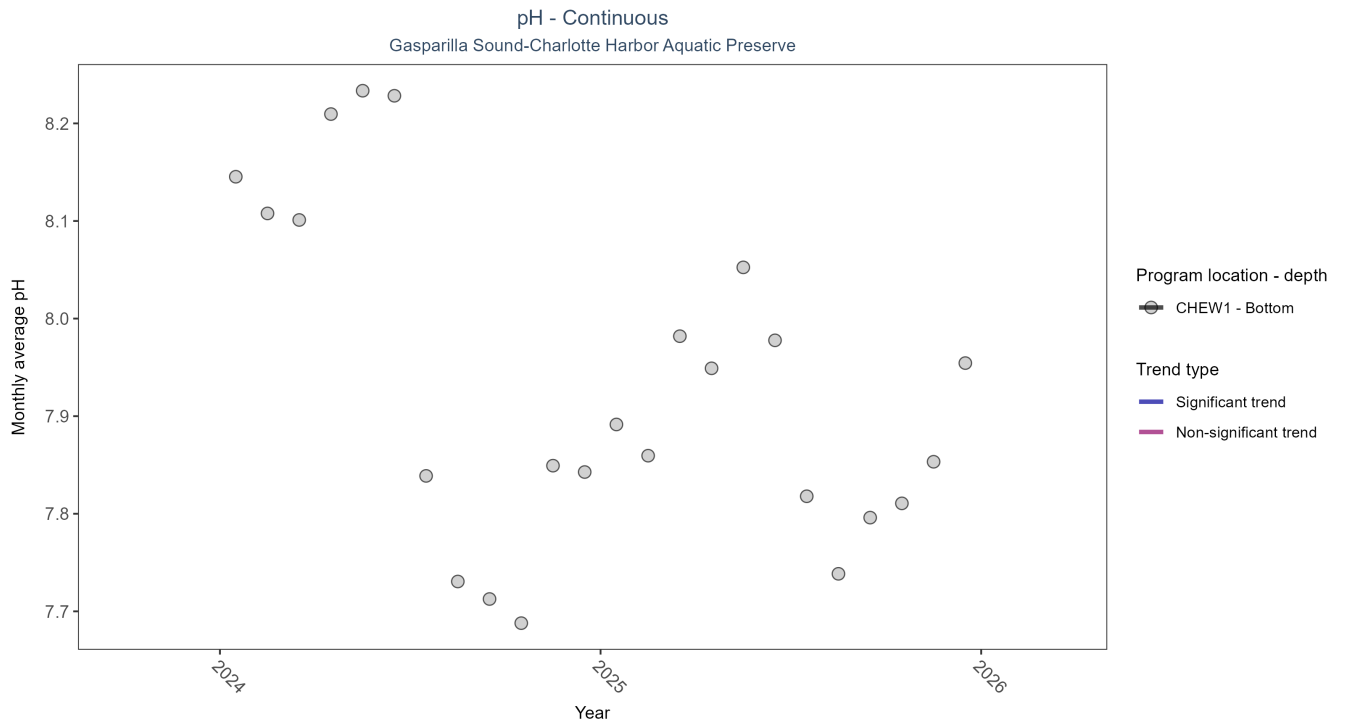


Figure 24: Scatter plot of monthly average pH over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 29: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for pH - All Stations

Program Location	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
CHEW1	Insufficient data to calculate trend	58569	2	2024 - 2025	7.9	-	-	-	-

There was insufficient data to fit a model for one location.

Dissolved Oxygen Saturation - Continuous

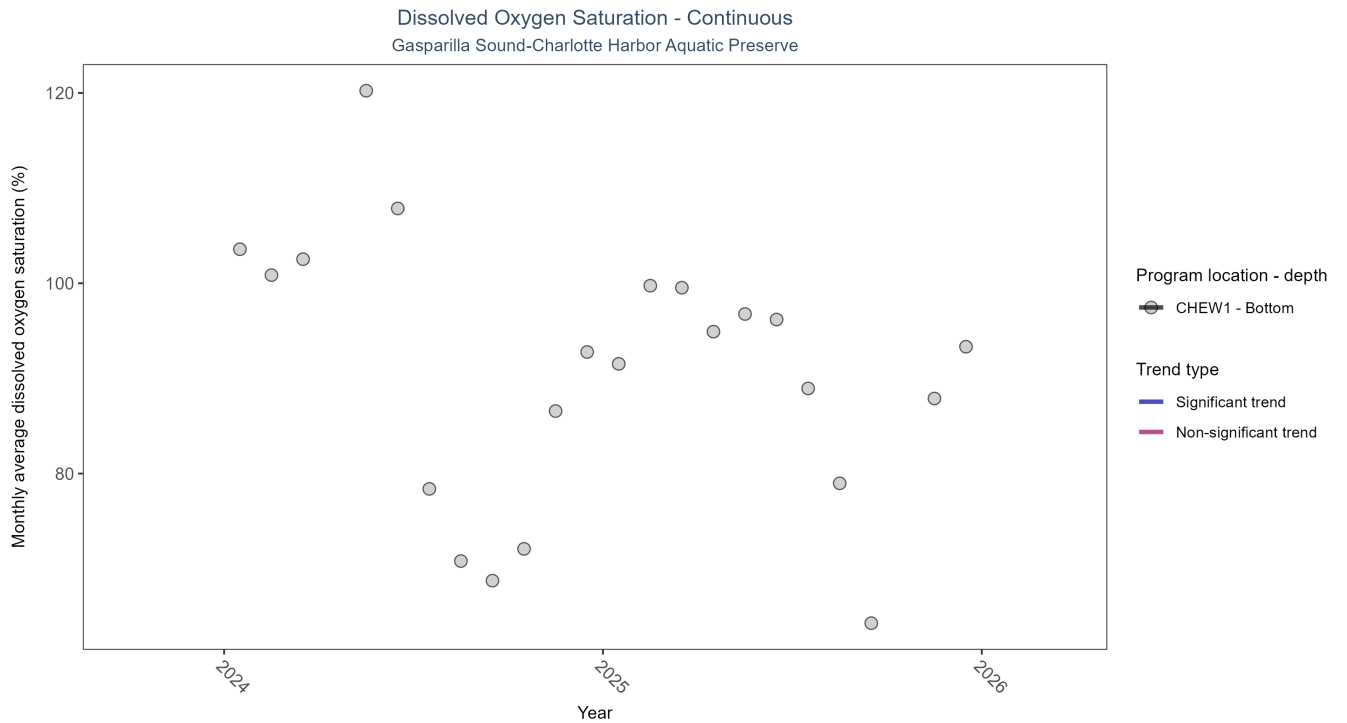


Figure 25: Scatter plot of monthly average dissolved oxygen saturation over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 30: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for Dissolved Oxygen Saturation - All Stations

Program Location	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
CHEW1	Insufficient data to calculate trend	51071	2	2024 - 2025	89.3	-	-	-	-

There was insufficient data to fit a model for one location.

Dissolved Oxygen - Continuous

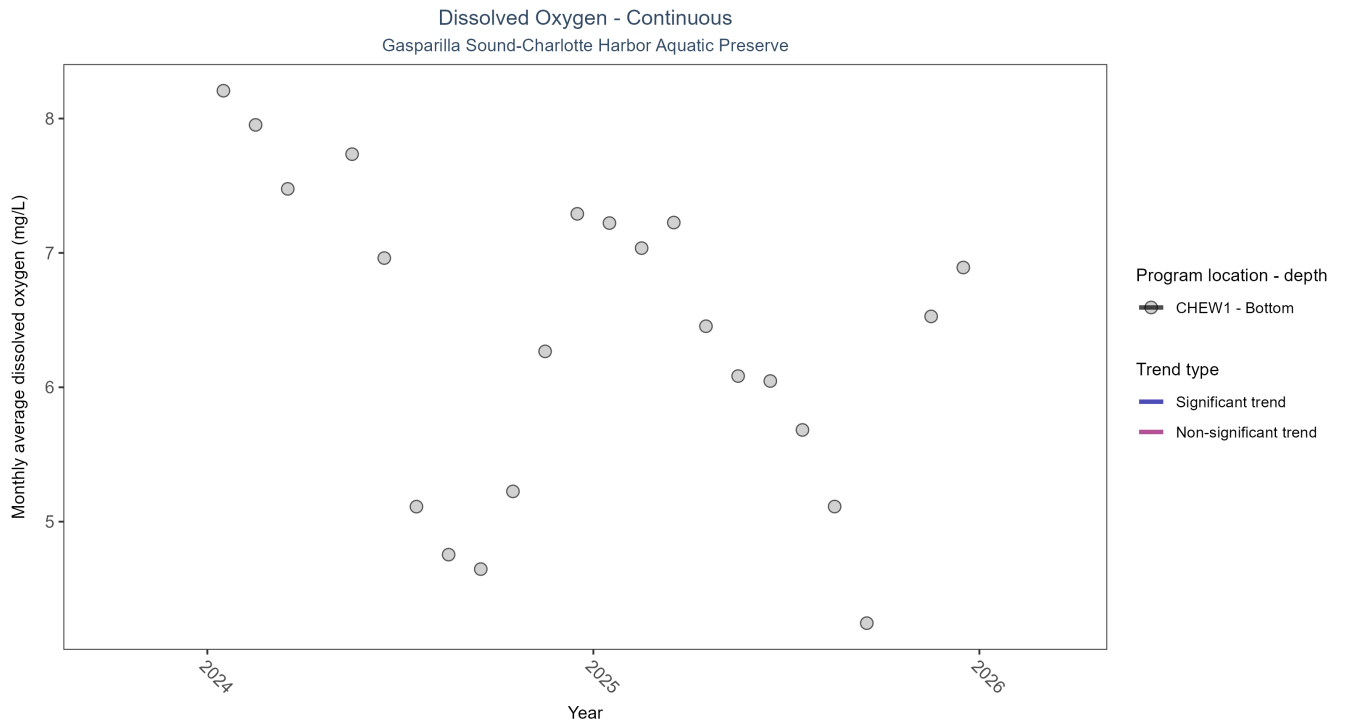


Figure 26: Scatter plot of monthly average dissolved oxygen over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 31: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for Dissolved Oxygen - All Stations

Program Location	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
CHEW1	Insufficient data to calculate trend	51073	2	2024 - 2025	6.3	-	-	-	-

There was insufficient data to fit a model for one location.

Turbidity - Continuous

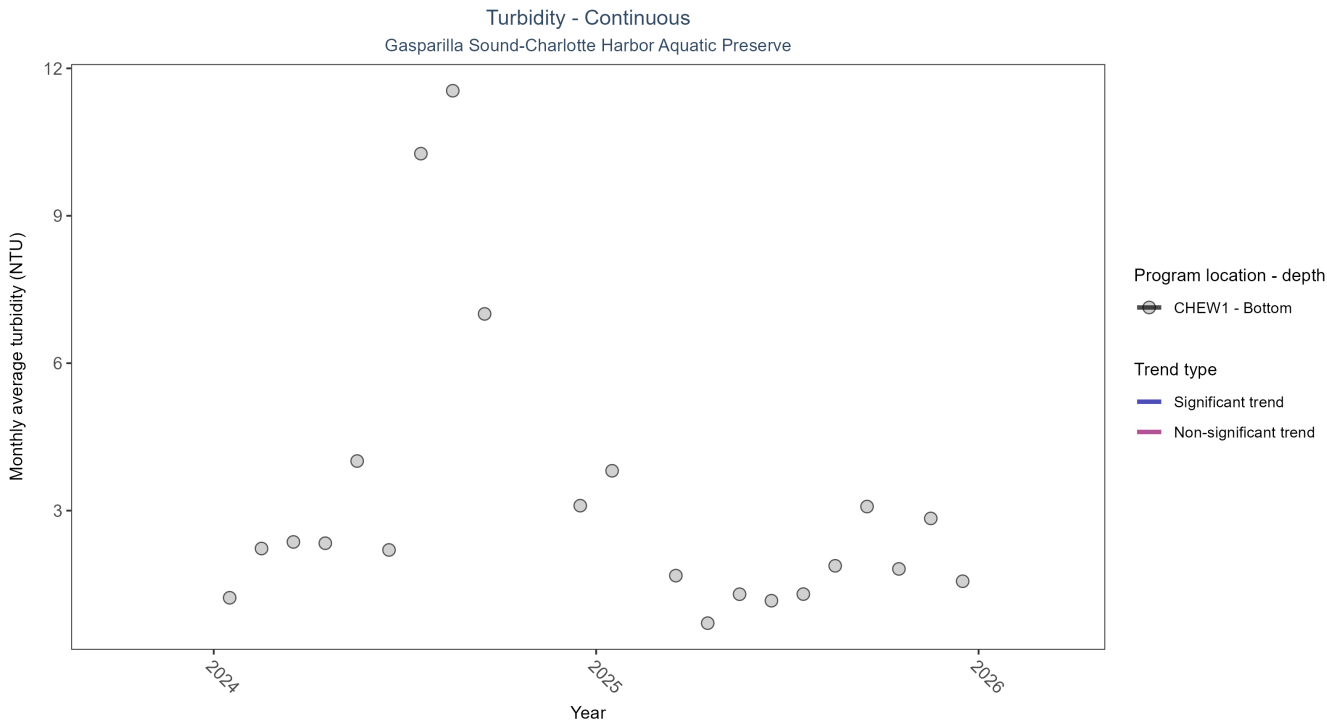


Figure 27: Scatter plot of monthly average turbidity over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 32: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for Turbidity - All Stations

Program Location	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
CHEW1	Insufficient data to calculate trend	47402	2	2024 - 2025	2	-	-	-	-

There was insufficient data to fit a model for one location.

Water Temperature - Continuous

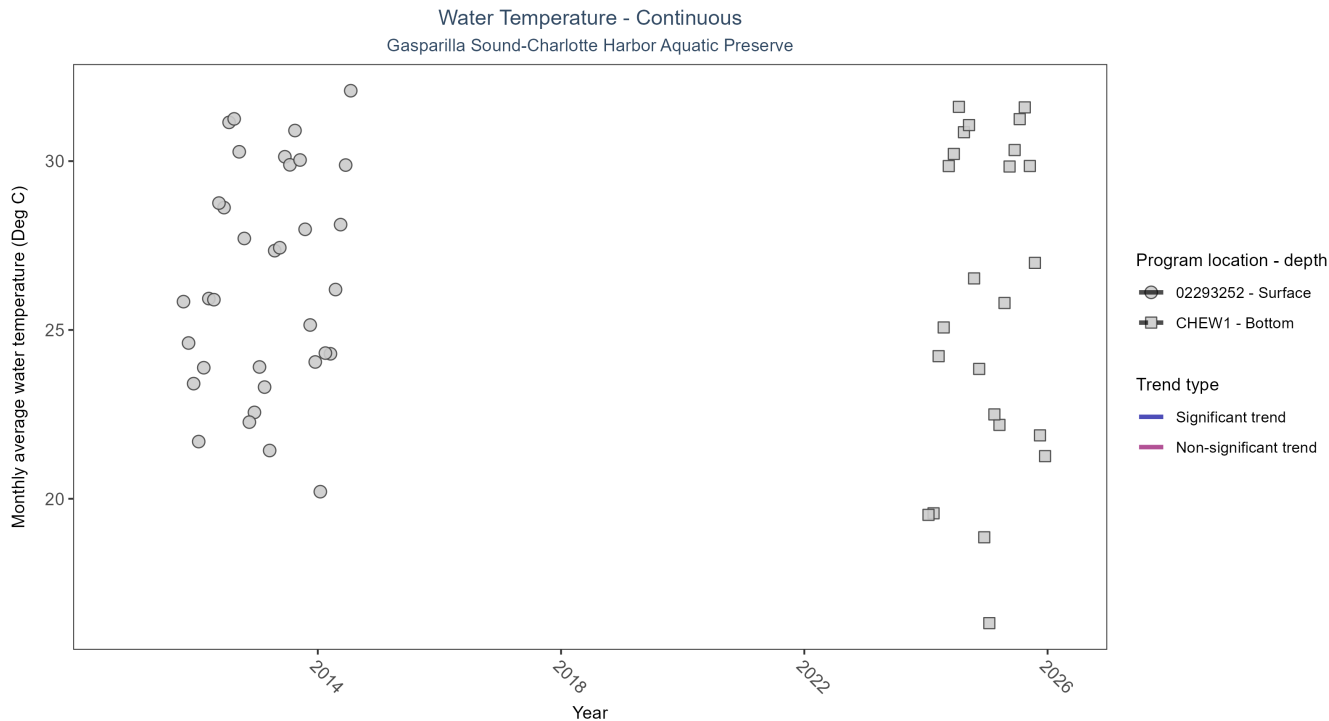


Figure 28: Scatter plot of monthly average water temperature over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 33: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for Water Temperature - All Stations

Program Location	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
02293252	Insufficient data to calculate trend	1003	4	2011 - 2014	26.4	-	-	-	-
CHEW1	Insufficient data to calculate trend	65195	2	2024 - 2025	27.1	-	-	-	-

There was insufficient data to fit a model for two locations.

Salinity - Continuous

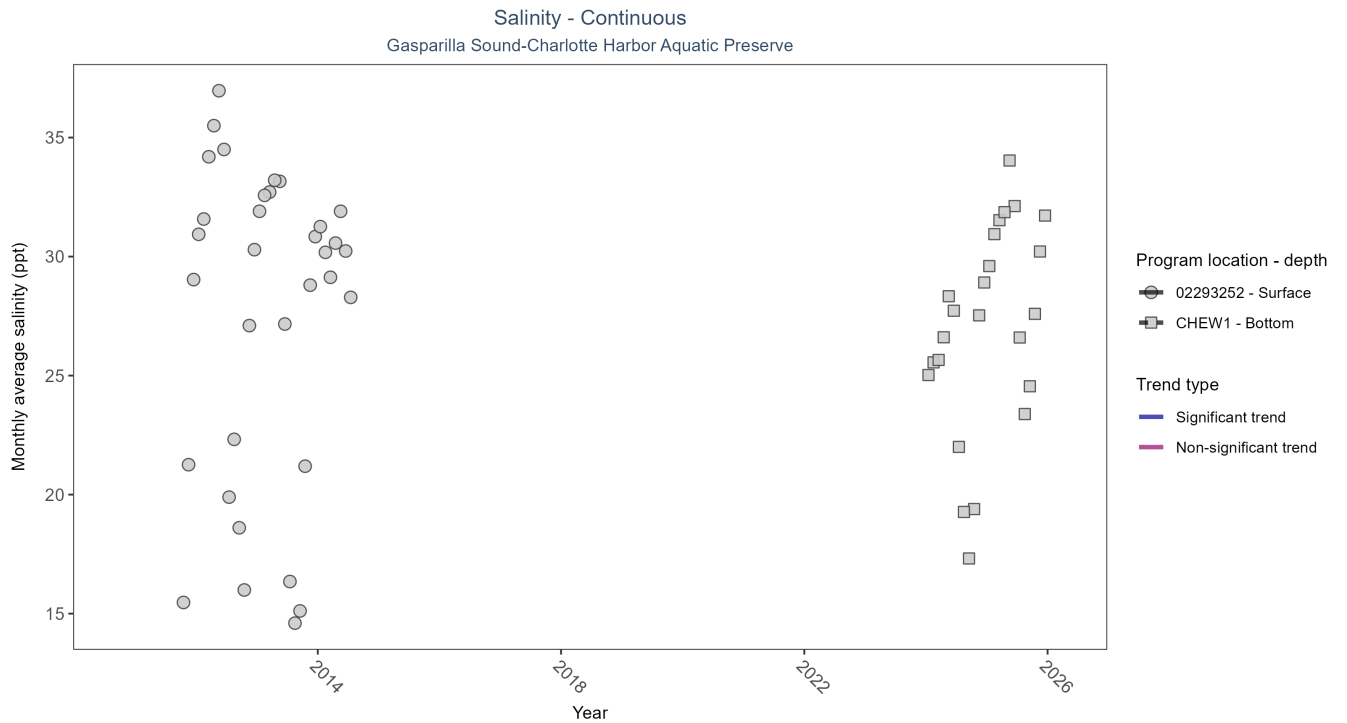


Figure 29: Scatter plot of monthly average salinity over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 34: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for Salinity - All Stations

Program Location	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
02293252	Insufficient data to calculate trend	1002	4	2011 - 2014	30.0	-	-	-	-
CHEW1	Insufficient data to calculate trend	64435	2	2024 - 2025	27.3	-	-	-	-

There was insufficient data to fit a model for two locations.

Specific Conductivity - Continuous

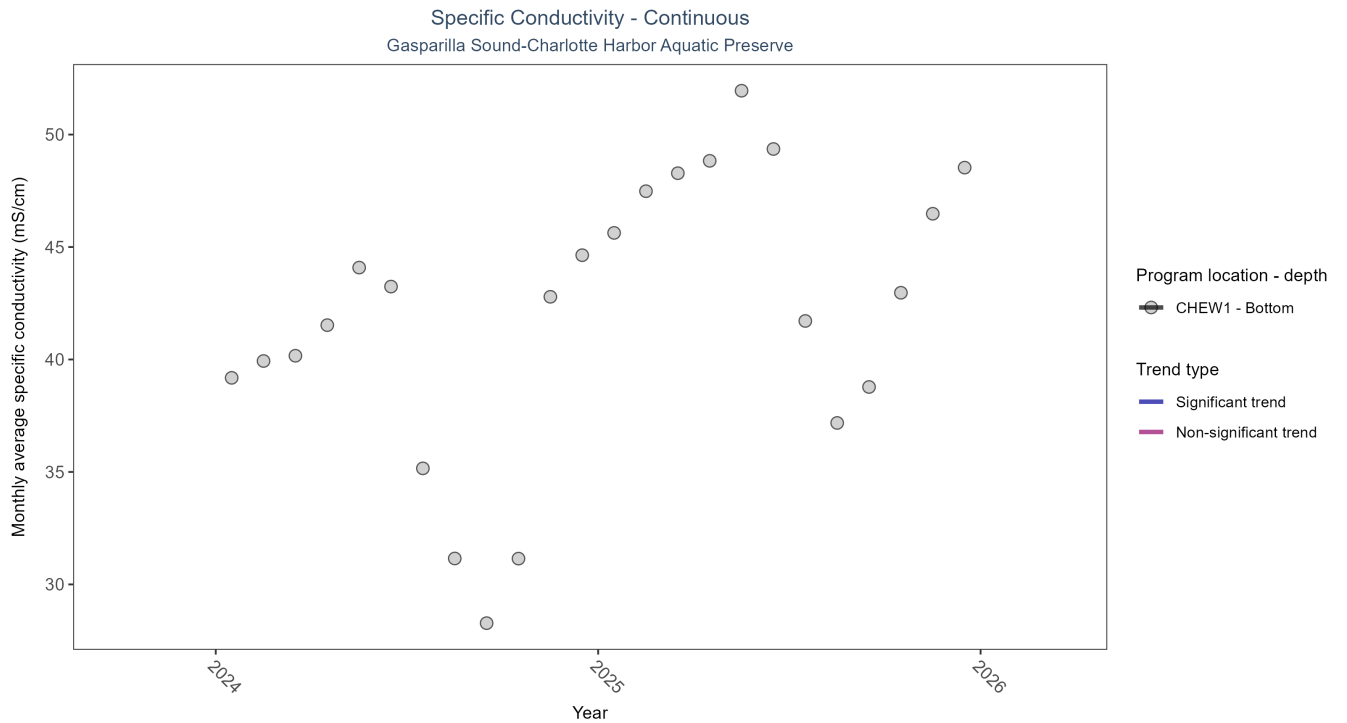


Figure 30: Scatter plot of monthly average specific conductivity over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 35: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for Specific Conductivity - All Stations

Program Location	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
CHEW1	Insufficient data to calculate trend	64435	2	2024 - 2025	42.52	-	-	-	-

There was insufficient data to fit a model for one location.

Submerged Aquatic Vegetation

The data file used is: **All_SAV_Parameters-2026-Jun-04.txt**

Submerged aquatic vegetation (SAV) refers to plants and plant-like macroalgae species that live entirely underwater. The two primary categories of SAV inhabiting Florida estuaries are *benthic macroalgae* and *seagrasses*. They often grow together in dense beds or meadows that carpet the seafloor. *Macroalgae* include multicellular species of green, red and brown algae that often live attached to the substrate by a holdfast. They tend to grow quickly and can tolerate relatively high nutrient levels, making them a threat to seagrasses and other benthic habitats in areas with poor water quality. In contrast, *seagrasses* are grass-like, vascular, flowering plants that are attached to the seafloor by extensive root systems. *Seagrasses* occur throughout the coastal areas of Florida, including protected bays and lagoons as well as deeper offshore waters on the continental shelf. *Seagrasses* have taken advantage of the broad, shallow shelf and clear water to produce two of the most extensive seagrass beds anywhere in continental North America.

Parameters

Percent Cover measures the fraction of an area of seafloor that is covered by SAV, usually estimated by evaluating multiple small areas of seafloor. Percent cover is often estimated for total SAV, individual types of vegetation (seagrass, attached algae, drift algae) and individual species.

Frequency of Occurrence was calculated as the number of times a taxon was observed in a year divided by the number of sampling events, multiplied by 100. Analysis is conducted at the quadrat level and is inclusive of all quadrats (i.e., quadrats evaluated using Braun-Blanquet, modified Braun-Blanquet, and percent cover.”

Species

Turtle grass (*Thalassia testudinum*) is the largest of the Florida seagrasses, with longer, thicker blades and deeper root structures than any of the other seagrasses. It is considered a climax seagrass species.

Shoal grass (*Halodule wrightii*) is an early colonizer of vegetated areas and usually grows in water too shallow for other species except *widgeon grass*. It can often tolerate larger salinity ranges than other seagrass species. *Shoal grass* is characterized by thin, flat blades, that are narrower than *turtle grass* blades.

Manatee grass (*Syringodium filiforme*) is easily recognizable because its leaves are thin and cylindrical instead of the flat, ribbon-like form shared by many other seagrass species. The leaves can grow up to half a meter in length. *Manatee grass* is usually found in mixed seagrass beds or small, dense monospecific patches.

Widgeon grass (*Ruppia maritima*) grows in both fresh and salt water and is widely distributed throughout Florida's estuaries in less saline areas, particularly in inlets along the east coast. This species resembles *shoal grass* in certain environments but can be identified by the pointed tips of its leaves.

Three species of *Halophila* spp. are found in Florida - **Star grass** (*Halophila engelmannii*), **Paddle grass** (*Halophila decipiens*), and **Johnson's seagrass** (*Halophila johnsonii*). These are smaller, more fragile seagrasses than other Florida species and are considered ephemeral. They grow along a single long rhizome, with short blades. These species are not well-studied, although surveys are underway to define their ecological roles.

Notes

Star grass, *Paddle grass*, and *Johnson's seagrass* will be grouped together and listed as **Halophila spp.** in the following managed areas. This is because several surveys did not specify to the species level:

- Banana River Aquatic Preserve
- Indian River-Malabar to Vero Beach Aquatic Preserve
- Indian River-Vero Beach to Ft. Pierce Aquatic Preserve
- Jensen Beach to Jupiter Inlet Aquatic Preserve
- Loxahatchee River-Lake Worth Creek Aquatic Preserve
- Mosquito Lagoon Aquatic Preserve

- Biscayne Bay Aquatic Preserve
- Florida Keys National Marine Sanctuary

Gasparilla Sound-Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserve
SAV Percent Cover - Sample Locations

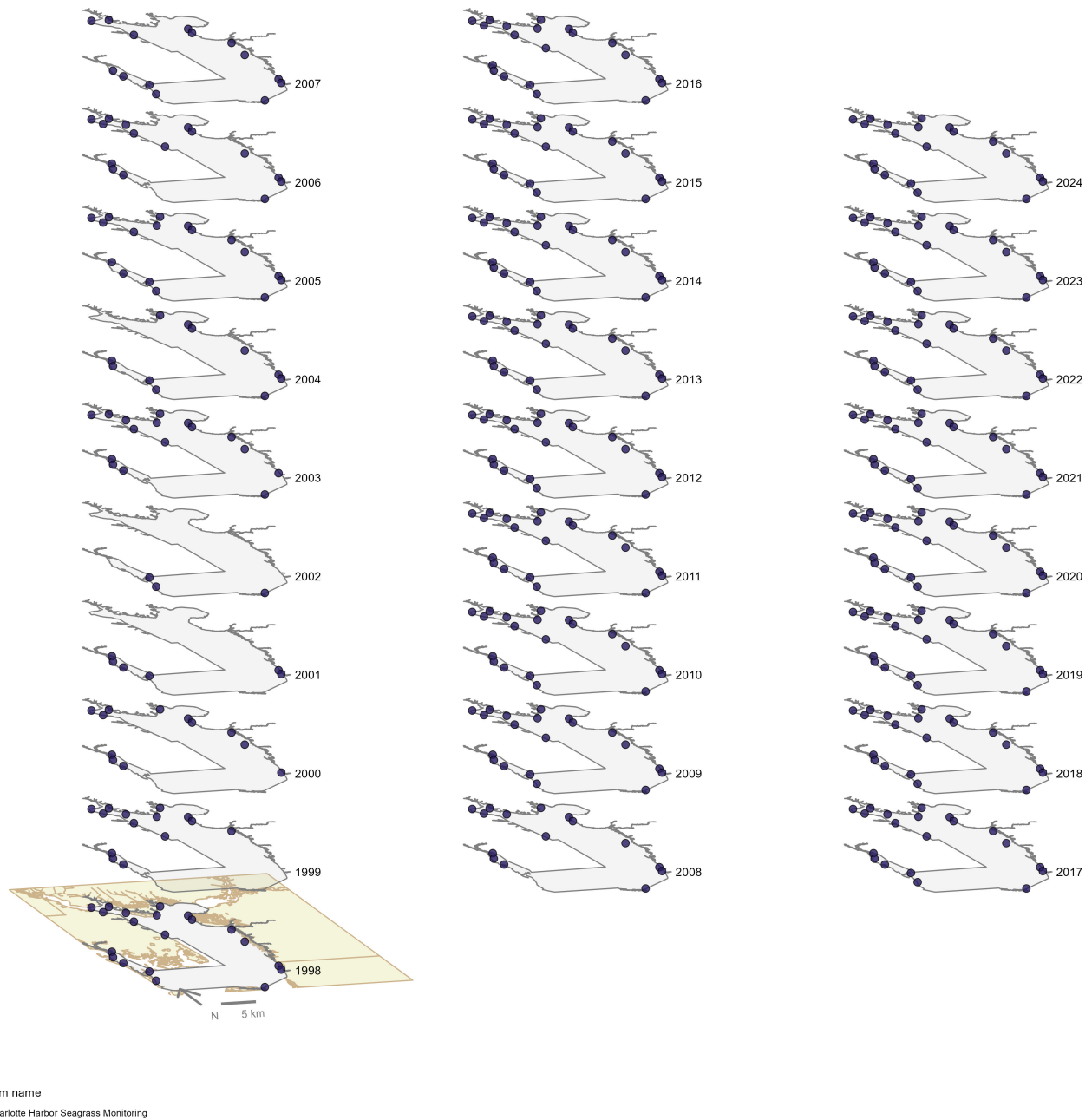


Figure 31: Maps showing the temporal scope of SAV sampling sites within the boundaries of *Gasparilla Sound-Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserve* by program name.

Click [here](#) to view spatio-temporal plots on GitHub.

Sampling locations by Program:

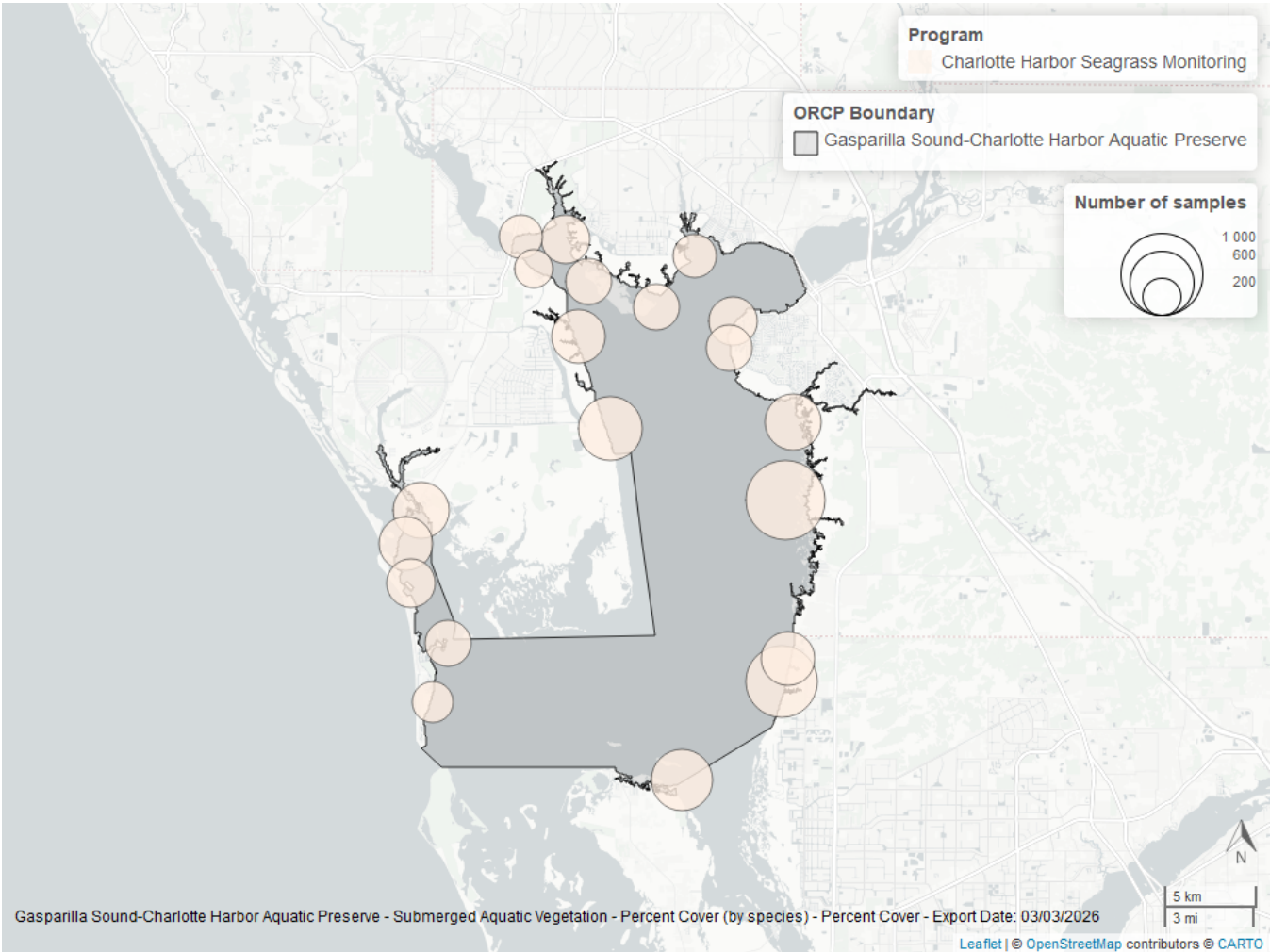


Figure 32: Map showing SAV sampling sites within the boundaries of *Gasparilla Sound-Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserve*. The point size reflects the number of samples at a given sampling site.

Table 36: Program Information for Submerged Aquatic Vegetation

<i>ProgramID</i>	<i>N-Data</i>	<i>YearMin</i>	<i>YearMax</i>	<i>method</i>	<i>Sample Locations</i>
570	8663	1998	2024	Braun Blanquet	20

Program names:

[570](#) - Charlotte Harbor Seagrass Monitoring¹⁶

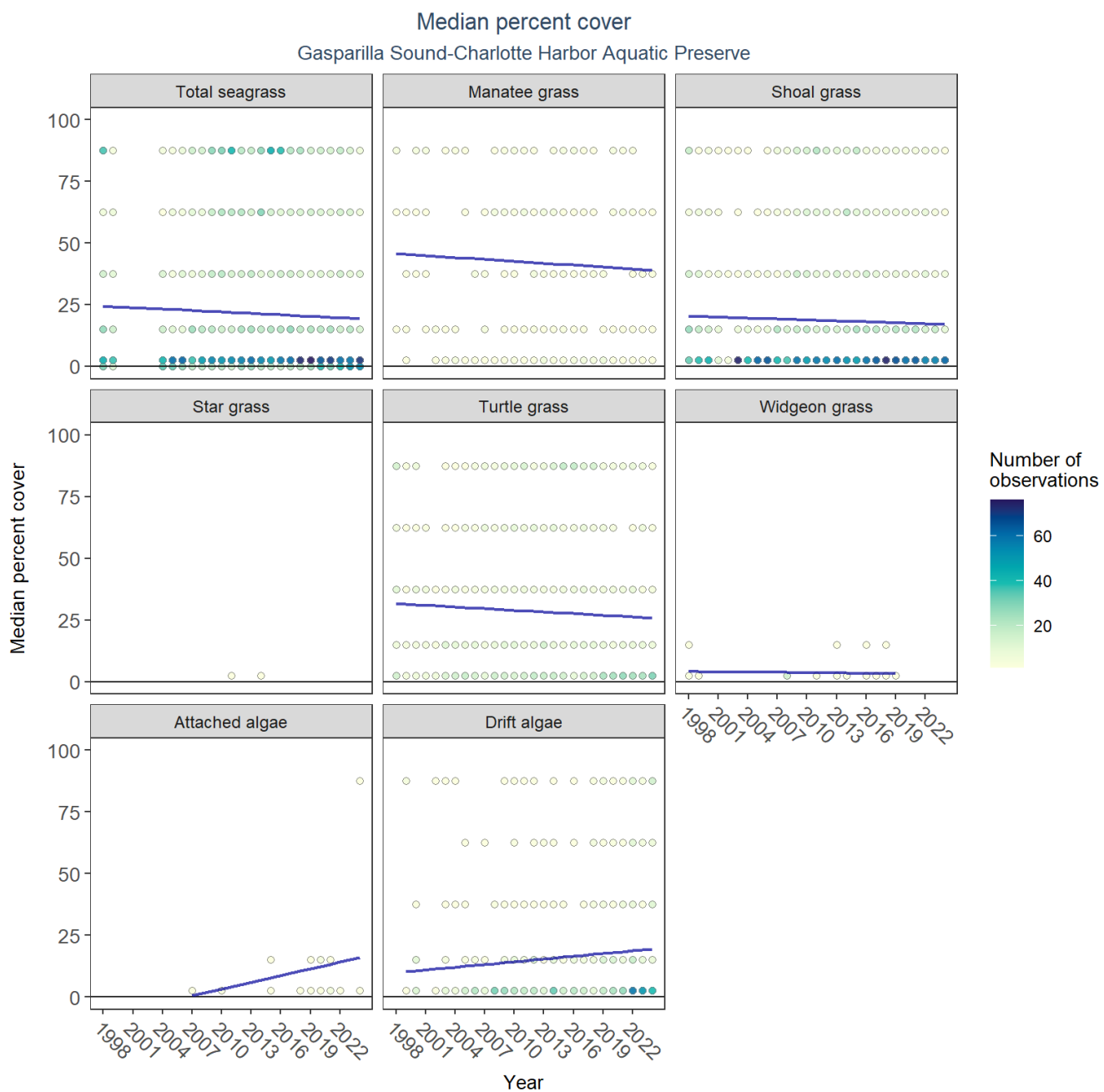


Figure 33: Scatter plots of median percent cover of submerged aquatic vegetation over time by group. Plots for time series that included five or more years of observations show the estimated trend as a blue line.

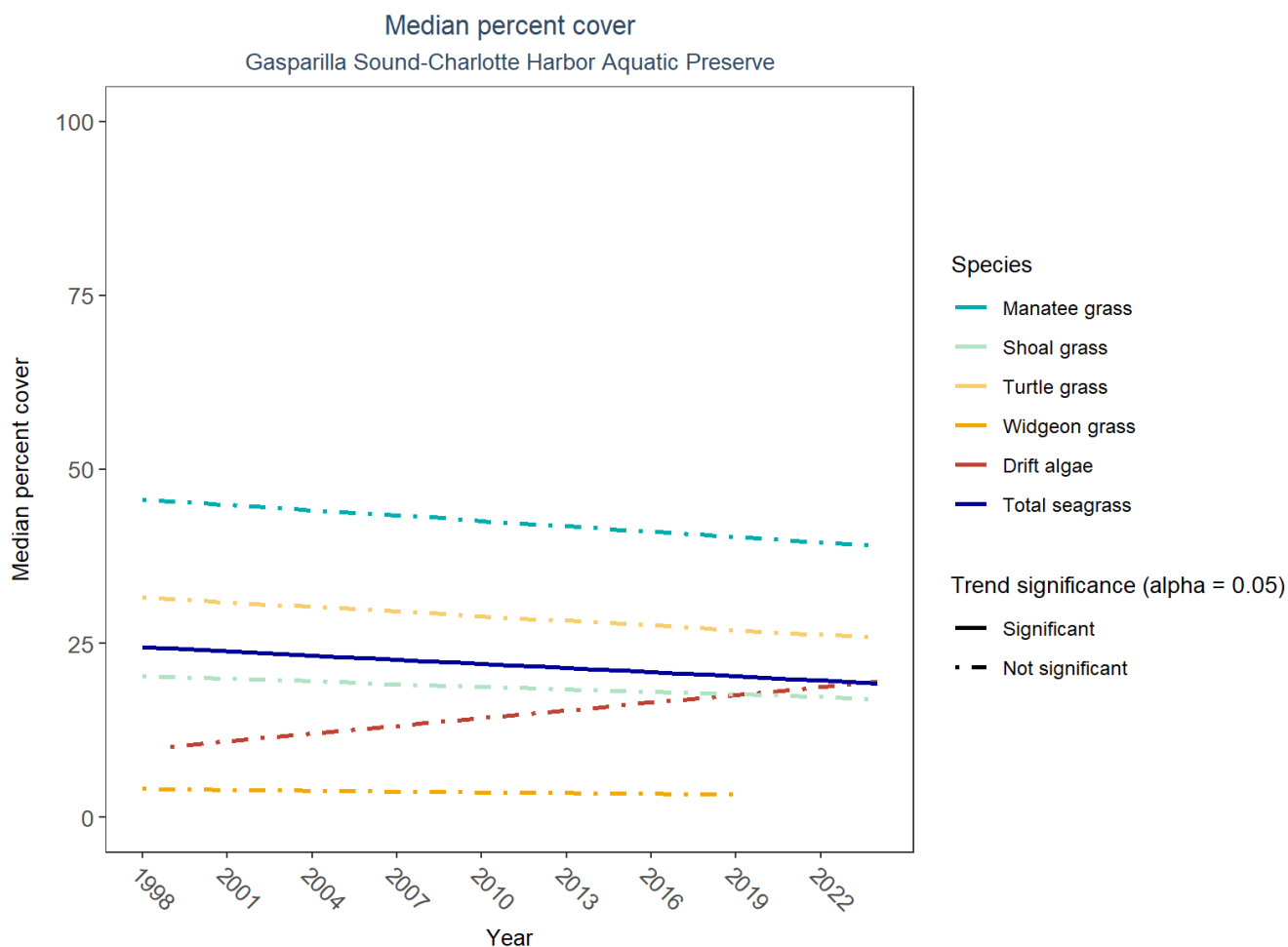


Figure 34: Trend lines of median percent cover of submerged aquatic vegetation over time for species that had five or more years of observations. Line type represents significance (solid) or non-significance (dashed) of the trends.

Table 37: Percent Cover Trend Analysis for Gasparilla Sound-Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserve

<i>Species</i>	<i>Statistical Trend</i>	<i>Period of Record</i>	<i>LME Intercept</i>	<i>LME Slope</i>	<i>P</i>
Attached algae	No detectable trend	2007 - 2024	-11.375093	0.9118092	0.2571900
Drift algae	No detectable trend	1999 - 2024	8.352811	0.3702923	0.1797771
Shoal grass	No detectable trend	1998 - 2024	20.792400	-0.1247684	0.0762040
Star grass	Insufficient data	-	-	-	-
Widgeon grass	No detectable trend	1998 - 2019	4.262001	-0.0392874	0.7955204
Manatee grass	No detectable trend	1998 - 2024	46.715525	-0.2566471	0.6220208
Turtle grass	No detectable trend	1998 - 2024	32.493342	-0.2225048	0.1352181
Total seagrass	Decreasing trend	1998 - 2024	25.252289	-0.1989084	0.0083590

An annual decrease in percent cover was observed for total seagrass (-0.20%). Manatee grass, shoal grass, turtle grass, widgeon grass, attached algae, and drift algae showed no detectable change in percent cover. Trends in percent cover could not be evaluated for star grass due to insufficient data.

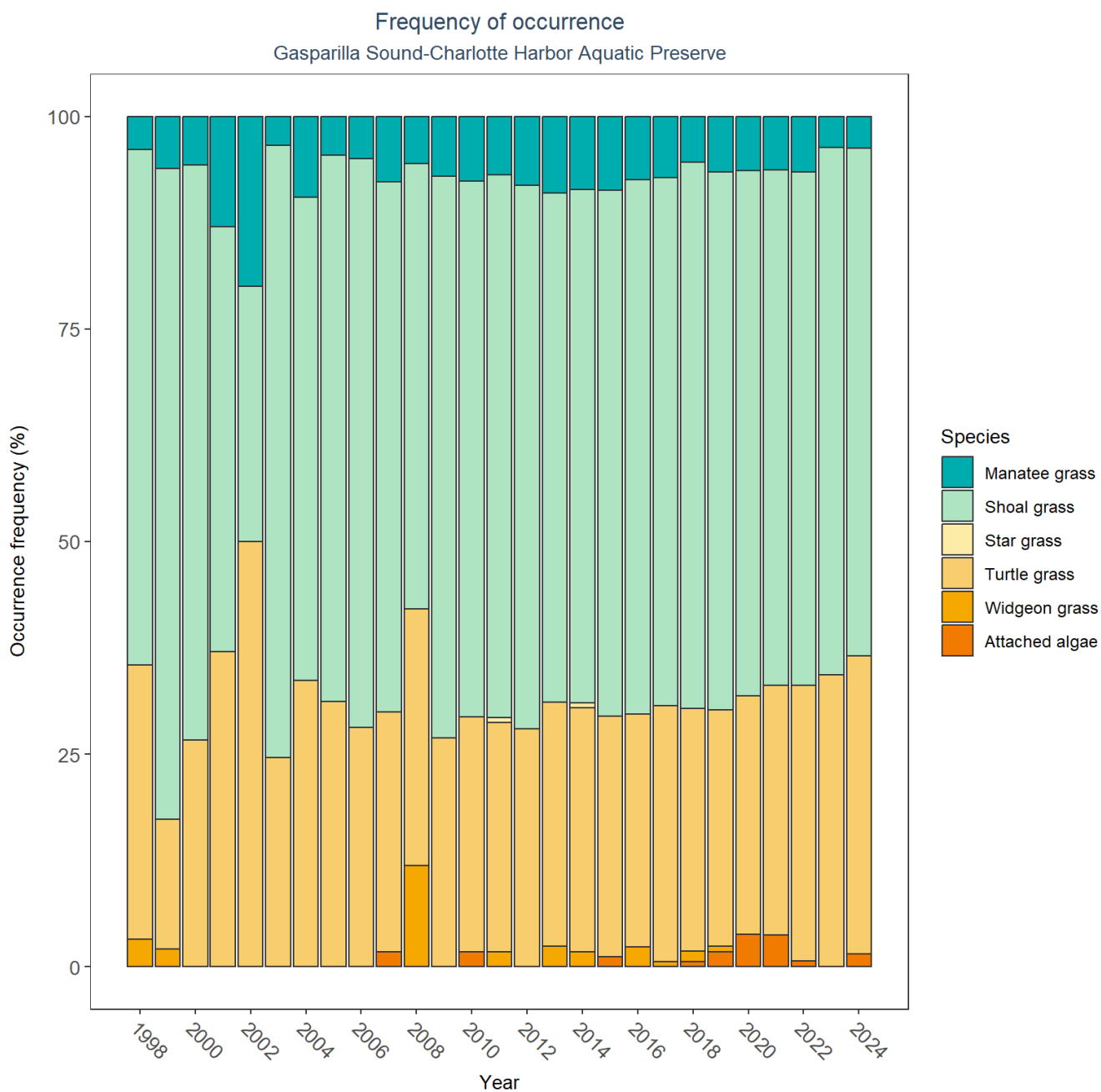


Figure 35: Bar plot of submerged aquatic vegetation species occurrence frequency over time by group.

SAV Water Column Analysis

The following parameters are available for Gasparilla Sound-Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserve within the SAV_WC_Report:

- Colored Dissolved Organic Matter
- Chlorophyll a
- Dissolved Oxygen
- Dissolved Oxygen Saturation
- pH

- Salinity
- Secchi Depth
- Water Temperature
- Total Nitrogen
- Total Suspended Solids
- Turbidity

Access the reports here: [DRAFT_SAV_WC_Report.pdf](#)

Species list

Caulerpa mexicana ¹	Halodule wrightii ¹	Syringodium filiforme ¹
Caulerpa prolifera ¹	Halophila engelmannii ¹	Thalassia testudinum ¹
Caulerpa sertularioides ¹	No grass in quadrat ¹	Total seagrass ¹
Caulerpa spp. ¹	Ruppia maritima ¹	Caulerpa mexicana ¹
Drift algae ¹	Sargassum buxifolium ¹	Caulerpa prolifera ¹

1 - Submerged Aquatic Vegetation

References

1. Charlotte Harbor National Estuary Program (CHNEP). [Coastal Charlotte Harbor Monitoring Network](#). (2024).
2. Florida Department of Environmental Protection (DEP). [Florida STORET / WIN](#). (2024).
3. Florida Department of Environmental Protection (DEP); Office of Resilience and Coastal Protection (RCP); Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves. [Charlotte Harbor Estuaries Volunteer Water Quality Monitoring Network](#). (2024).
4. Florida Department of Environmental Protection (DEP); Office of Resilience and Coastal Protection (RCP); Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves. [Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves Monthly Water Quality Program](#). (2024).
5. University of Florida (UF); Institute of Food and Agricultural Sciences. [Florida LAKEWATCH Program](#). (2024).
6. U.S. Environmental Protection Agency (EPA). [EPA STORage and RETrieval Data Warehouse \(STORET\)/WQX](#). (2023).
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